Climate Refugee Stories: Project Guide

Please note: CMS is used to refer to the Content Management System.

If referring to the Climate Migration Syllabus, it has been written out.

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Content Management System (CMS)

About

A Content Management System (CMS) allows users to create and edit content on a website without needing to work with code. Netlify is what we used for hosting the CMS for the Climate Refugee Stories website and authenticating users via GitHub.

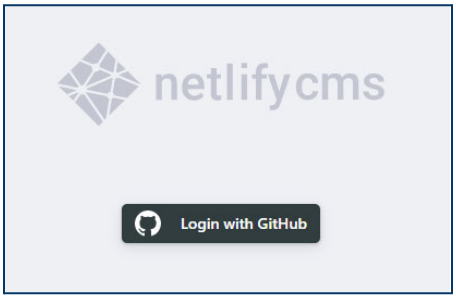
CMS Access

Link

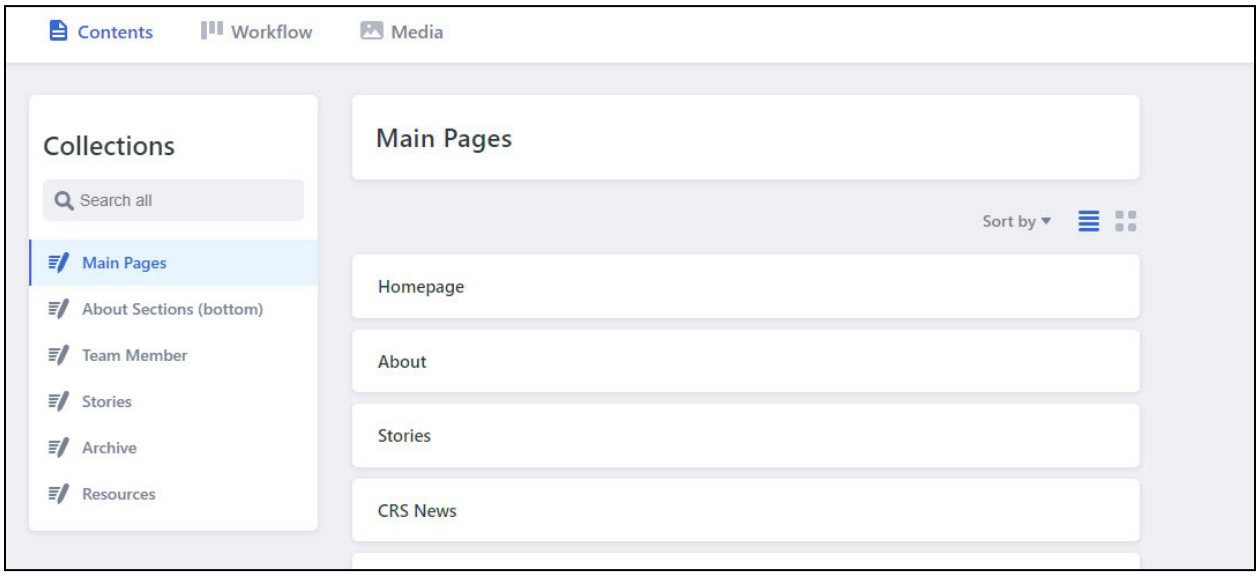
Go to: [redacted]

Login

If not already logged in, you can **Login with GitHub**



Once logged in, you should see the following.



Brief Orientation

🎥 [redacted]

You can also see more on where/how to use the CMS for specific sections/content on the website in the CRS Website Breakdown section.

Shortcodes

About

Hugo shortcodes are custom HTML that you can use inside your Markdown content, when using a Hugo theme like we are with the Kross theme. You can learn more about Hugo here, and check out Hugo's documentation here.

Instead of needing to type in the shortcodes, Alex has added these into the CMS. You can click on the "+" button shown below to see the dropdown list of all shortcode options available.



All options prepended with (CRS) are the ones that we set up and work without any issue, whereas we can't guarantee the others will work properly for your current setup. See a breakdown of the options below.

If you want to delete a shortcode section added (like in image below), you can hit the backspace key while it's selected (blue border around item).



You can see some examples of the shortcodes and their usage in the orientation video above.

Markdown

Markdown is a more human-readable language used for things like blog posts. With the shortcodes now built into the CMS, you shouldn't have to worry about most things in Markdown. However, for basic Markdown help, below are some good resources.

Markdown Resources:

- The Ultimate Markdown Cheat Sheet
- Markdown Cheat Sheet

Rich Text

The Rich Text view lets you see plain text and images, relatively close to how they'll appear online (minus any special styling). You should be able to see things like Bold, Italics, Headers, etc.

Inline CSS

You can add inline CSS to the text to get more specific styling, like making colored text. The easiest thing to use for this is probably tags like in the example below. Then, you can use whatever property-value combinations you want inside the " " after `style=`. In the example below, we used the property `color` which is the text-color, and gave it a value of `red`.

Example: Here we added red text.

```
{{< center >}}

<span style="color: red">Coming Soon: Stories from Hurricane Dorian</span>

{{< /center >}}
```

The easiest thing to do if there are any styles/formatting you use often is to create a custom shortcode. But if you need something quick, like a new color for a section of text, then this is okay to do.

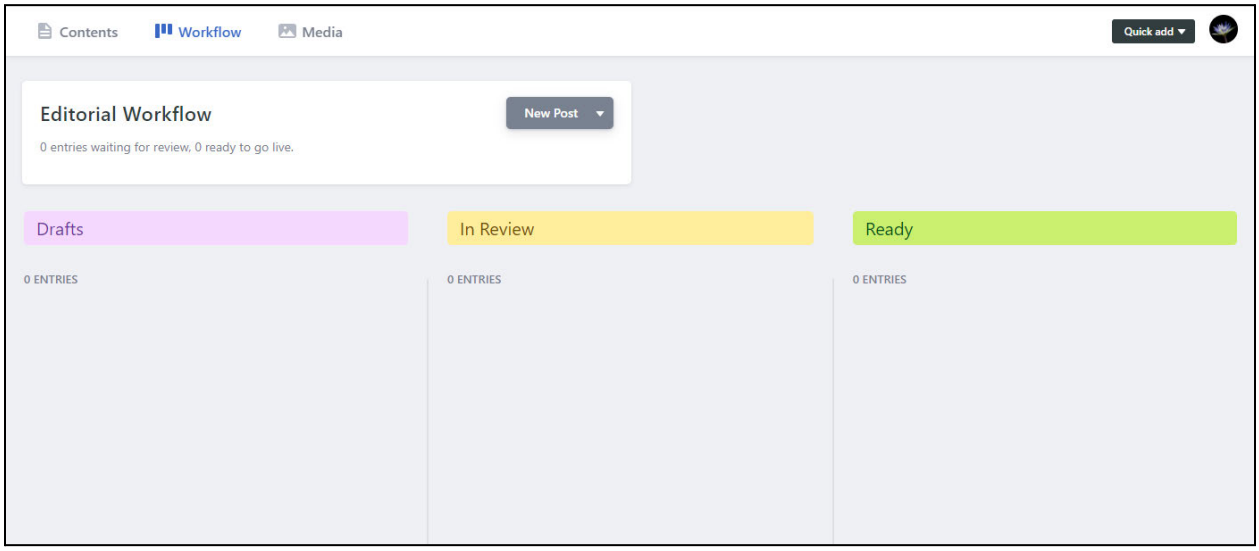
Resources for inline CSS:

- CSS Properties
- CSS Tutorial

Workflow

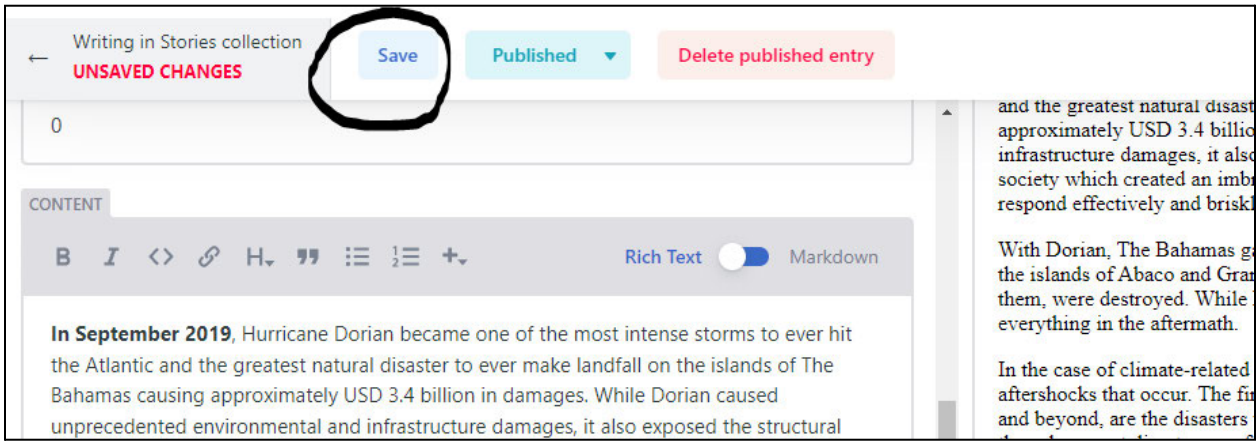
Below will show the status of any content being created or edited by you or your team members. If something is marked as “Ready,” you can publish it from here as well. Currently, it is set up to have any content from other team members require your (admin) approval, so only you can publish. You can publish without the review process as admin.

The “New Post” button will also let you create certain types of content from this screen.

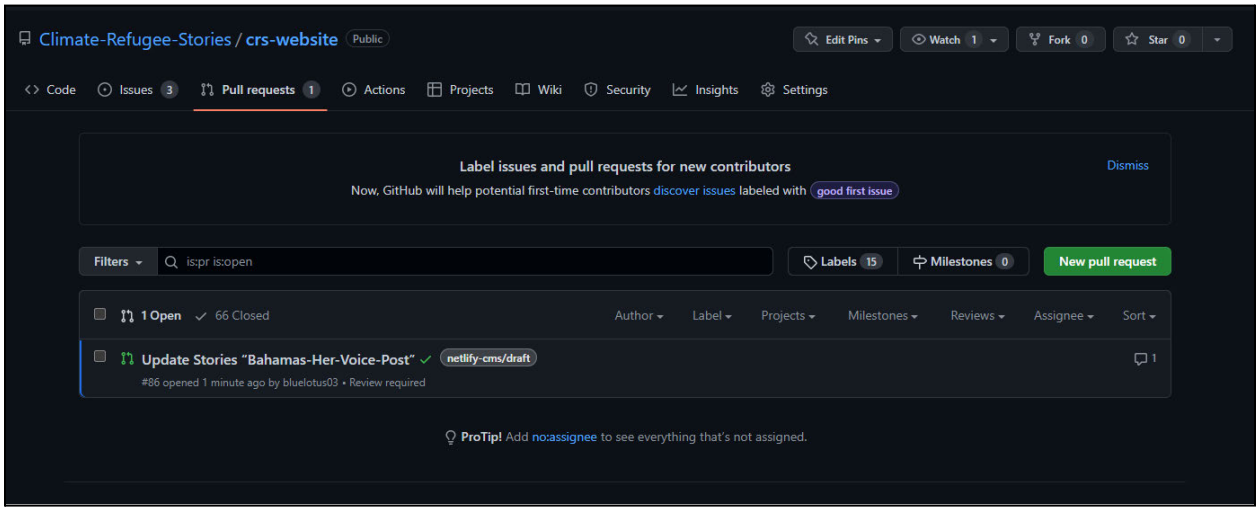


Creating & Editing Content

Once you are done with newly created or edited content, click the “Save” button. Once you click “Save”, the status should change to “Draft” (even if it was previously published content).

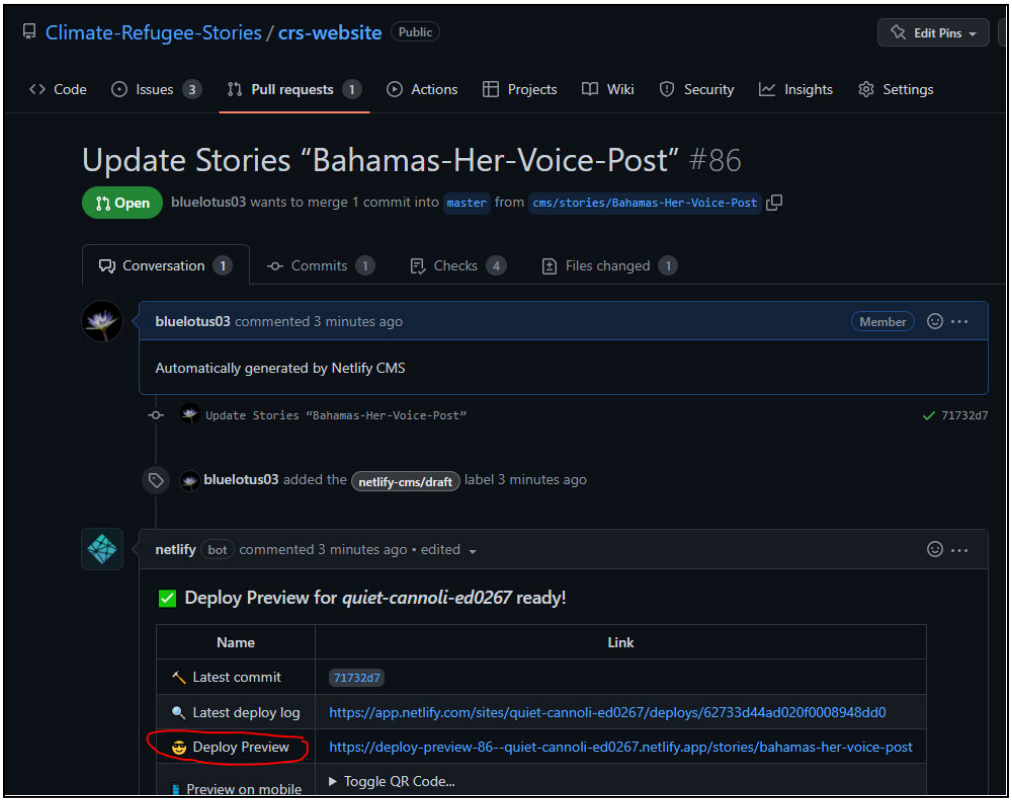


By saving these changes, you will now see a new Pull Request (PR). That PR will show the status as well (“Draft” or “Ready”).



Viewing Changes

If you click on the PR, you will see a link to view a preview of these changes from Netlify using the link labeled “Deploy Preview”.

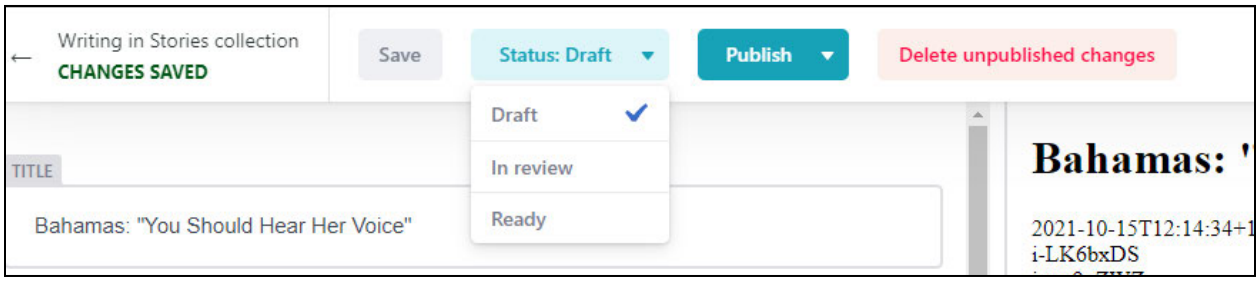


Note: There is a difference between changes saved as “Draft” and the “Draft” toggle in posts (like pic below). Changes saved as “Draft” are staged to be published, while the “Draft” toggle hides a post from the publishing process completely.

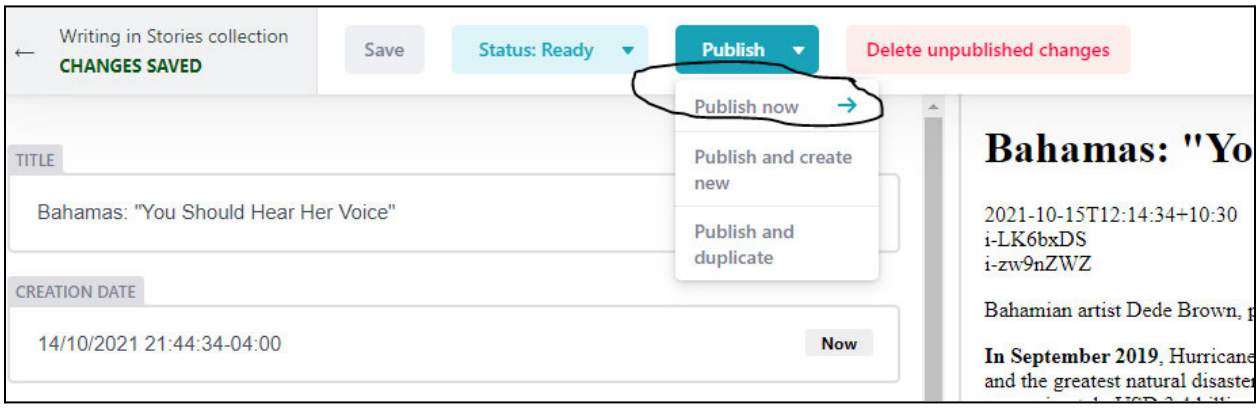
So if you want to save changes to be reviewed and published, the “Draft” status like shown above in the drop down is what you want. If you want to create a post that will not be completed for a while, or if you want to hide content from the live site without deleting it, you can use the “Draft” toggle.

Publishing/Deleting

If everything looks good and you’re ready to publish, you can change the status back in the CMS to “Ready.” (Feel free to also use the “In review” status if you want to let other team members know you’re looking over their content.) You will have to mark the content as “Ready” before you can publish it.

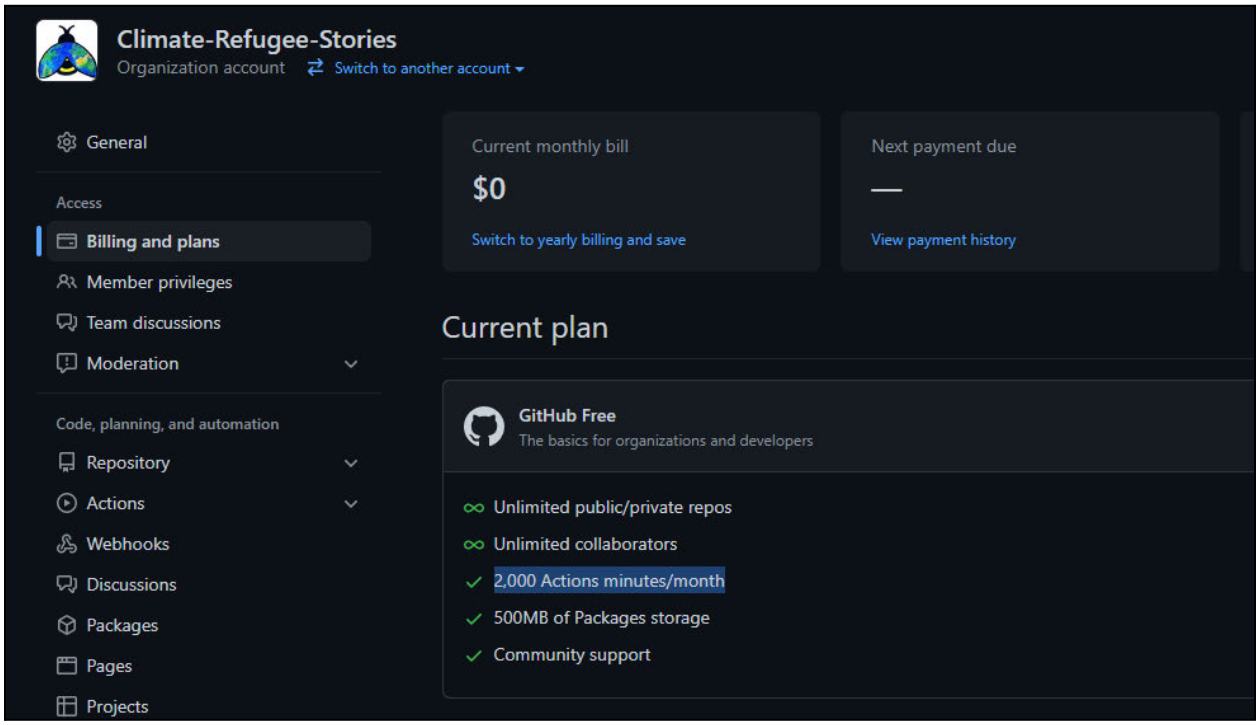


You can publish with the option “Publish now,” and this will merge that PR with the main (master) branch (live site). If you don’t want to publish these changes, you can use the red “Delete unpublished changes” button and it will close the PR without merging.



Notes on Publishing:

- It may take a couple minutes after publishing something for it to show on the live site. (New changes cause the site to re-deploy)
- There is a limit to the number of times you can update the main (master) branch each month since you are on a free GitHub account. That limit is based on “action minutes” which is basically the minutes used during re-deployments and maintenance tasks. It’s a large number, but we wanted to note it so you were aware.



Media Management

Photo Sizing

When replacing or adding photos to specific sections of the website, try to keep them the same size as the other photos used for that purpose (Examples: story cover photos, team member headshots, etc.). This will ensure the best visual results and responsiveness with the current setup. Below you can find the sizes for the different types of photo uses.

Story Covers

1600 x 800

Story Thumbnails

300 x 300

Archive Collection Covers

Size shouldn't matter for these.

Archive Collection Thumbnails

Size shouldn't matter for these.

Team Member Headshots

368 x 376

If there are any others you come across that aren't listed here, you can view their current size in SmugMug. Sizing may not matter for things like the gallery images, where the code takes care of the way they are displayed. You can always see how things look in the deployment preview before publishing as well.

Using SmugMug

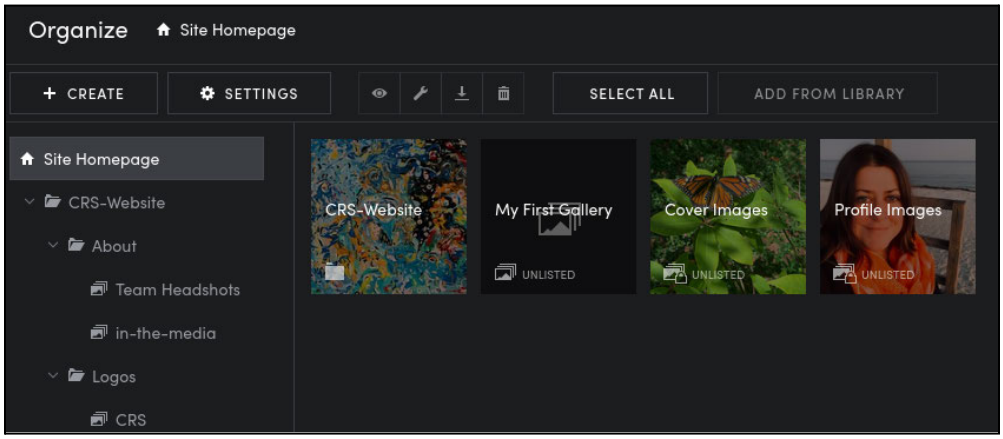
Here is a pretty good intro guide on how to use SmugMug.

Something else to consider in the future is possibly allowing people to download specific images, that you can allow them to buy from you, and that purchase of an image (that they think is unique or identify with) could be a donation to the CRS organization.

SmugMug facilitates allowing people to buy the image, currently I've turned it off but it's something to think about for the future.

Current Setup

You can see the "Organize" view here. From there you can see all the pictures that were uploaded and the folders we have uploaded them into, which are organized with subfolders.



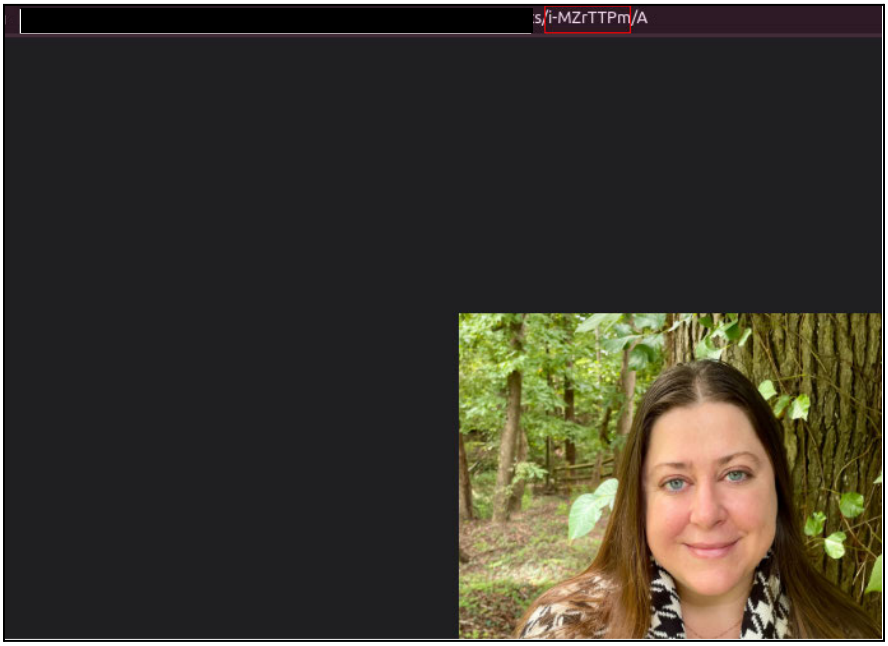
Note: A grouping of pictures is called a "Gallery" in SmugMug.

Uploading Photos

Check out SmugMug's documentation for how to upload items.

Getting Photo IDs

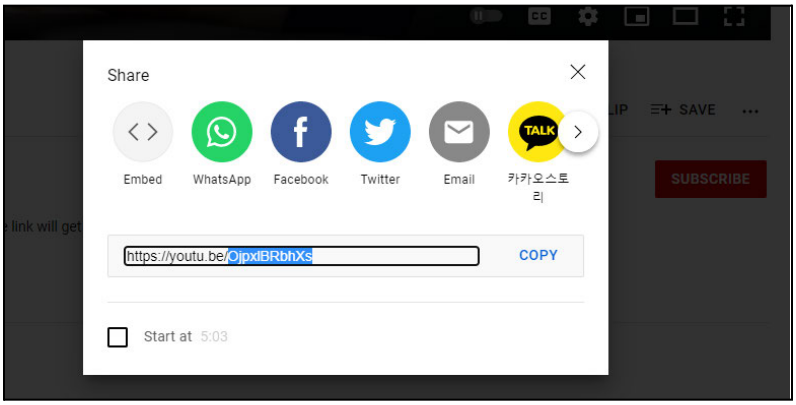
When viewing your SmugMug site you can get the photo IDs after you click on an image. If you take your headshot for example, then you would end up grabbing the *i-MZrTTPm* from the URL (excluding the last "/" and any character(s) after).



YouTube Videos

Getting Video IDs

You can grab YouTube Video IDs by clicking "Share" under the video and copying the ending characters (everything after the last "/").



CRS Website Breakdown

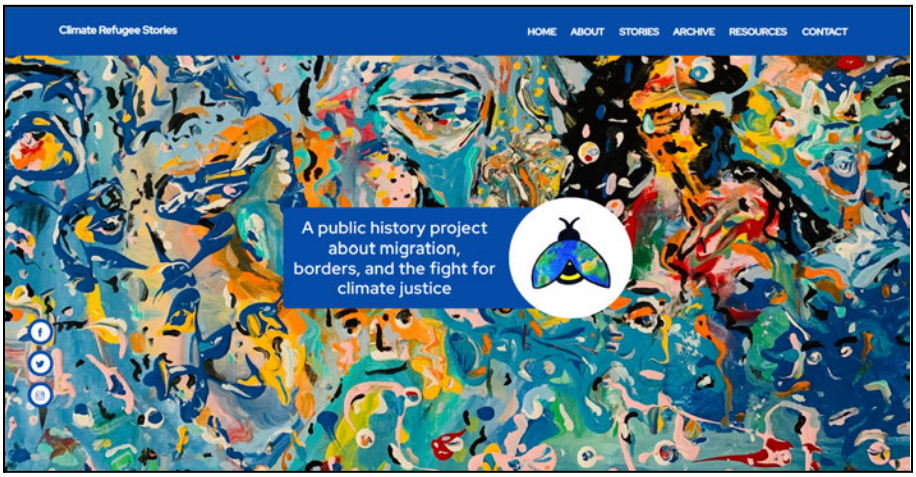
🎥 [redacted]

Below you can see the paths in the CMS to edit content in each section on the different pages of the website. If a path mentions GitHub, this is not something that can be edited in the CMS (a bit more difficult), but we included the file paths in GitHub in case you want to edit it there.

If there is an item that is not listed as a change for GitHub or the CMS, it's a more extensive change and you can see the General Styling section.

Home

Hero Section



You can edit the following in Main Pages/Homepage:

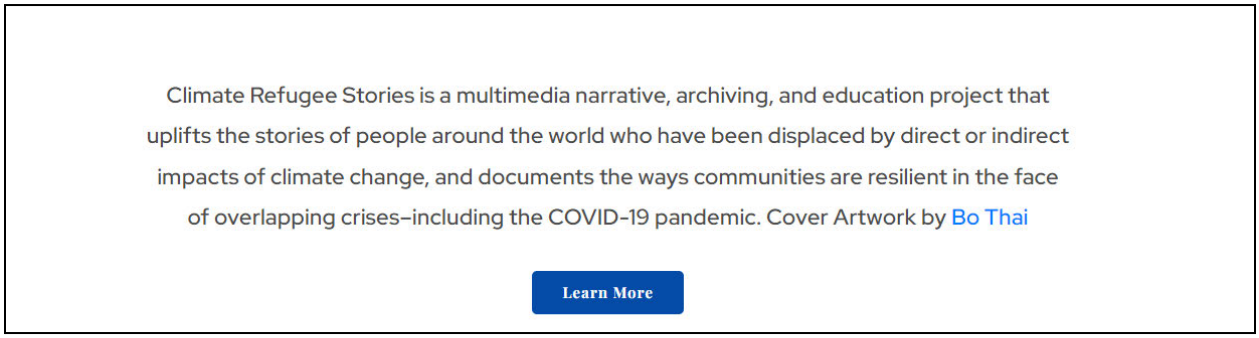
- Banner Section: Slogan, Background Image, Logo on top of Background Image

You can edit the following in Main Pages/Contact:

- Socials: Social link + Icon *(These are used on the home page and the contact page.)*
  Note: I would limit to 3 social icons at any given time with the current styling setup. For example, you could change a link or swap out a social media account for another but it would be better visually not to remove one completely. To do that, it would likely need a bit of styling work (especially to keep responsiveness looking good).

  To replace icons, you can use the options in the Brand Icons section of the Themify website, and simply swap out the name of the icon for the one you want (Example: ti-dropbox).

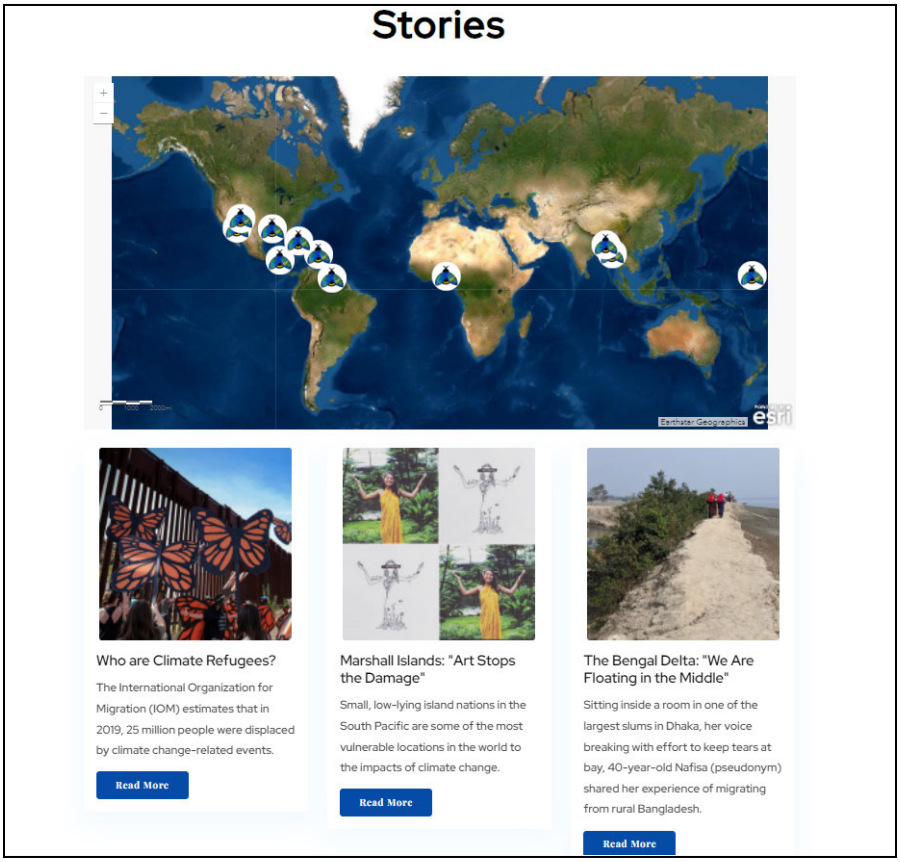
Introduction



You can edit the following in Main Pages/Homepage:

- About Section: About Text, Button Text + Link (Learn More)

Stories Section



You can edit the following in Main Pages/Homepage:

- Stories Section: Stories Section Title, Map URL

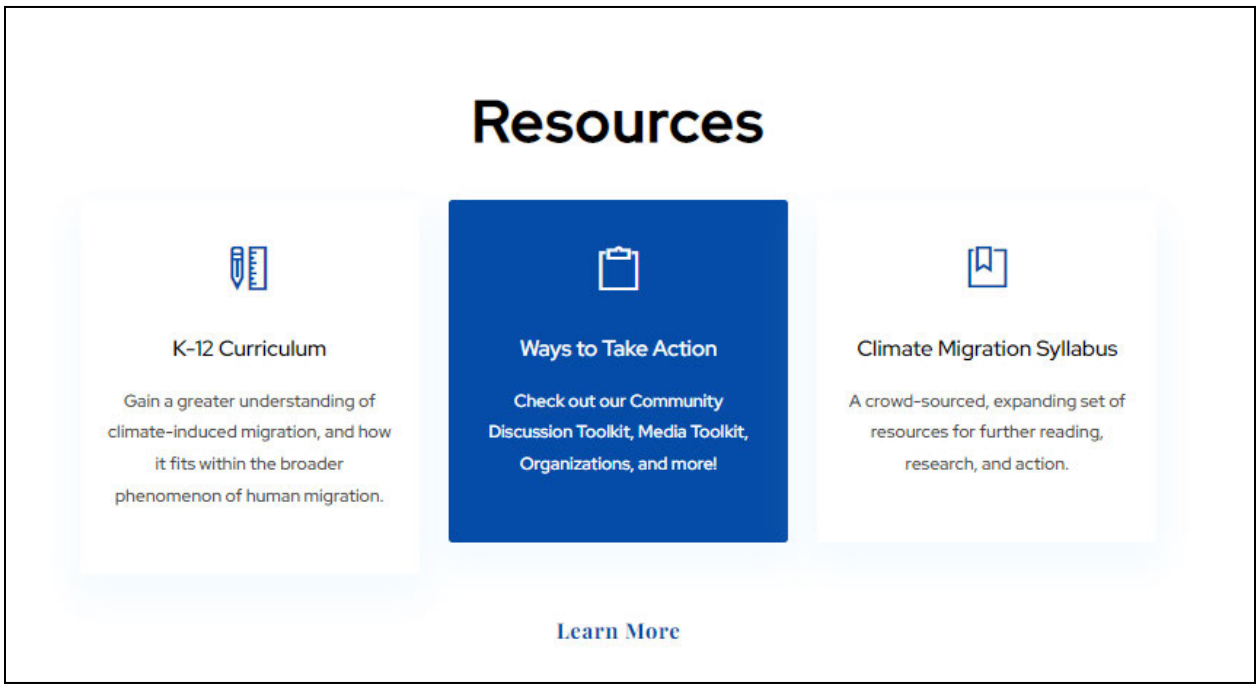
Archive Section



You can edit the following in [Main Pages/Homepage]:

- Archive Section: Archive Section Title, Archive Articles to Show (# to preview here)

Resources Section



You can edit the following in [Main Pages/Homepage]:

- Resources Section: Resources Section Title, Button Link + Text (Learn More), Items Content (title, description, link, icon)

Note: The linked action text such as “Learn More” above or “Visit the Climate Migration Syllabus” on the Resources page are referred to as buttons, even though they do not have the background like the “Learn More” in the introduction section on the home page. This is because they are technically still labeled as buttons in the code (essentially so that they pull from certain styling classes).

Our Partners Section



You can edit the following in [Main Pages/About]:

- Partners Section: Section Title, Intro Text, Partner Logos + Links *(this is used on the home page and the about page)*

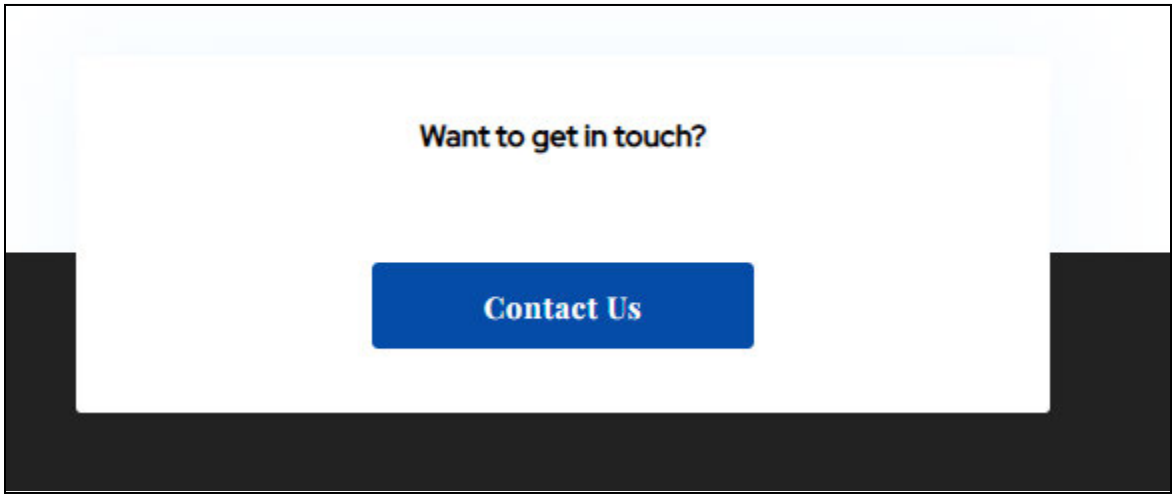
Tweets Section



You cannot edit this section in the CMS, but the GitHub file path is included below:

- layouts/index.html → Lines 237 - 239

CTA Section

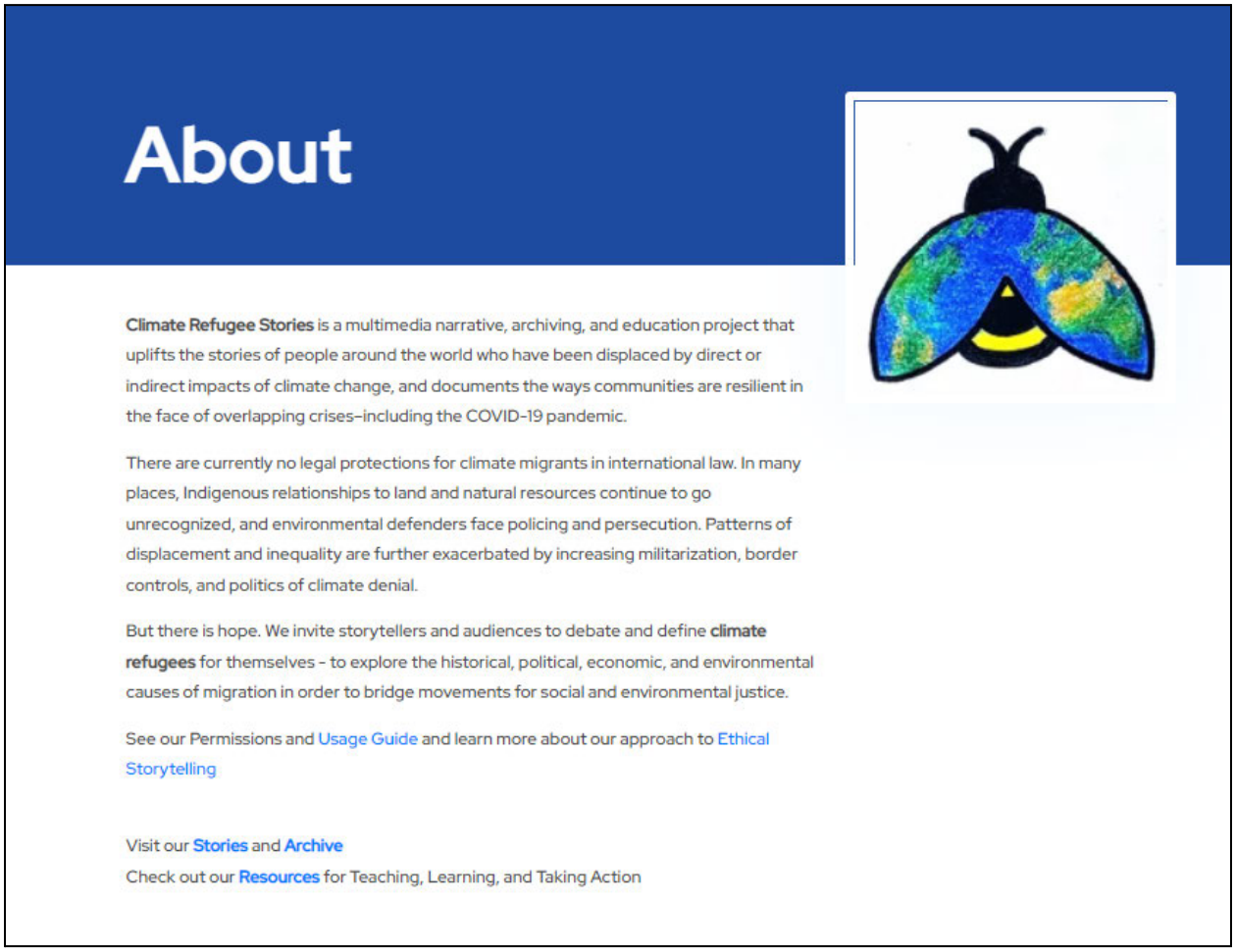


You cannot edit this section in the CMS, but the GitHub file path is included below:

- layouts/partials/footer-contact.html → Lines 8 - 11

About

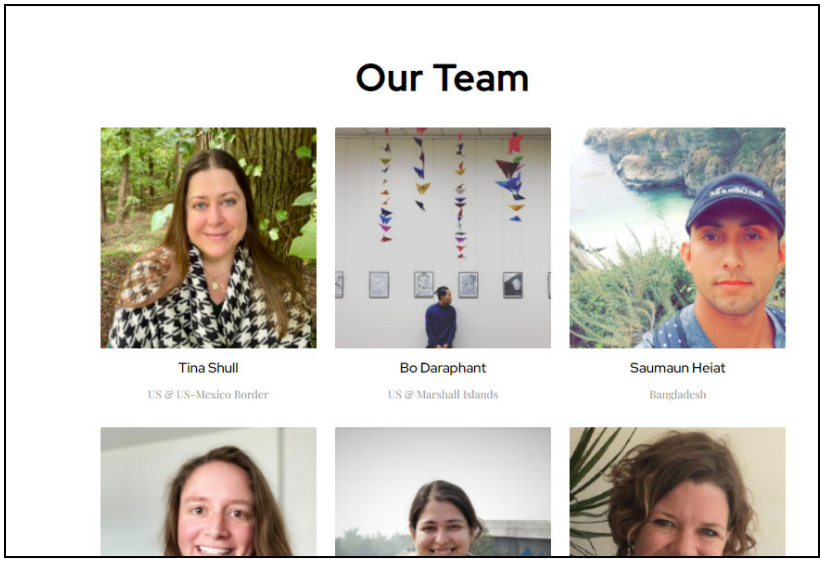
About Us Section



You can edit the following in Main Pages/About:

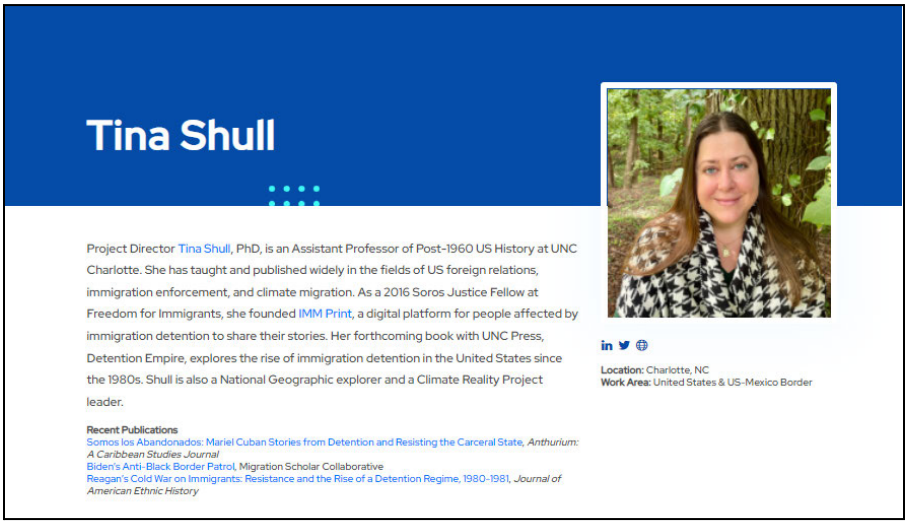
- Title at Top of Page Section: Page Title
- Content Section: About Us Text

Our Team Section



(These are edited in individual team member pages below)

Individual Team Page



You can edit the following in [Team Member]:

- All Team Members and Their Information for the Individual Page

  Note: You can add, edit, and delete team members here. If adding new ones or swapping out images, make sure they are the same size as the previous image for best visual results.

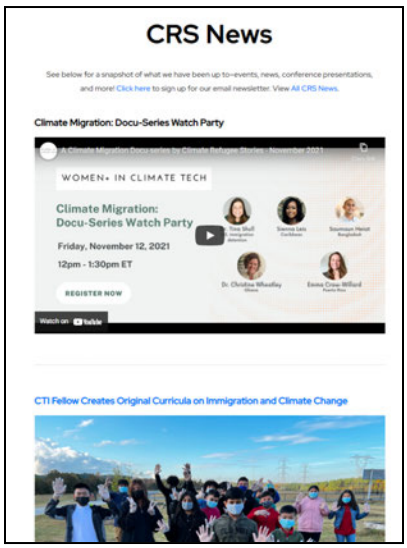
Our Partners Section

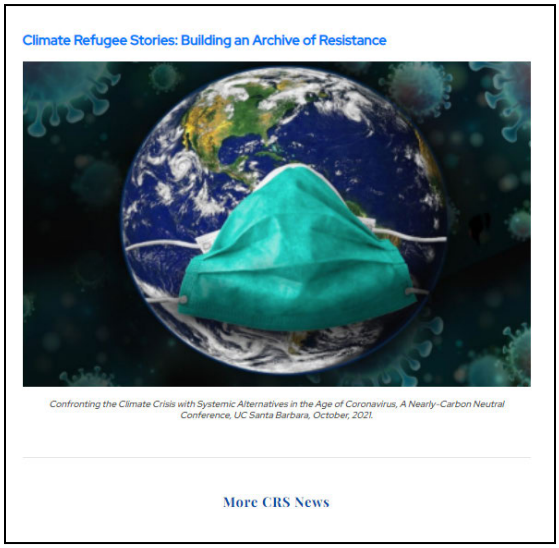


You can edit the following in [Main Pages/About]:

- Partners Section: Section Title, Intro Text, Partner Logos + Links *(this is used on the home page and the about page)*

CRS News Section

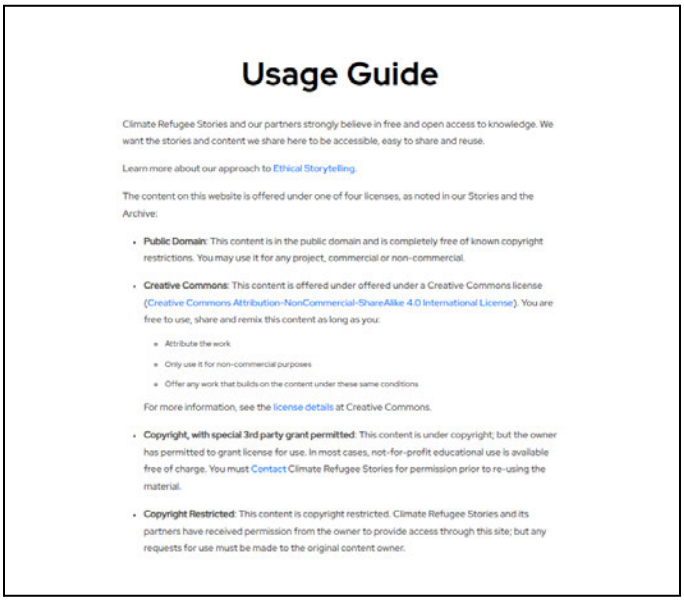




You can edit the following in [About Sections (bottom)/CRS News]:

- Section Title, Intro Description, Content (Images, Videos, Titles, Captions, and Alt Text), Button Text + Link (More CRS News - at end of section)

Usage Guide Section

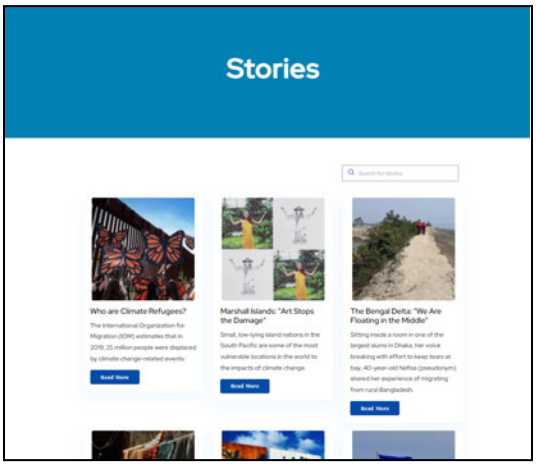


You can edit the following in [About Sections (bottom)/Usage Guide]:

- Section Title, Content, Button Text + Link (optional button at end of section like the one in CRS News section - currently disabled)

Stories

List Page



You can edit the following in Main Pages/Stories:

- Page Title

Individual Story Page



You can edit the following in Stories:

- All Individual Stories Content

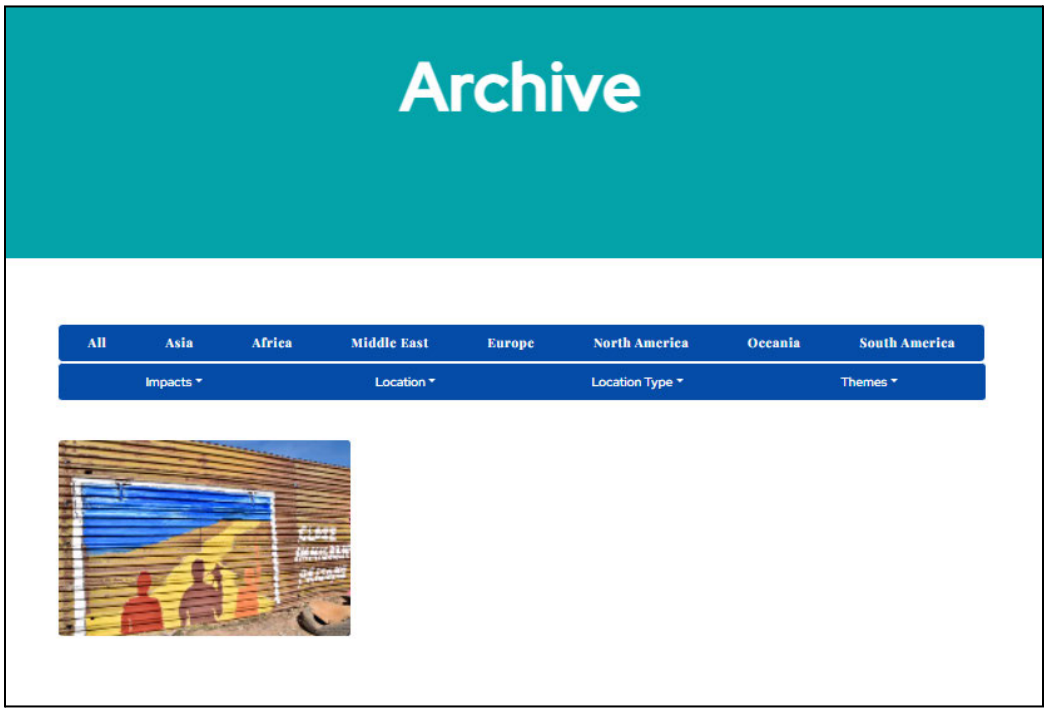
  Note: The “Order” field when creating/editing an individual story will allow you to control the order that your stories appear in. “0” means there is no order, and these stories will

go in order of their date from newest to oldest. “1” means the first story to show, and you can use increasing numbers to specify what comes next.

After you’ve reached the end of your numbered stories, that is when the stories with “0” will begin from newest to oldest. If you have 2 posts with the same number, they will also be shown in order of creation date from newest to oldest.

Archive

List Page

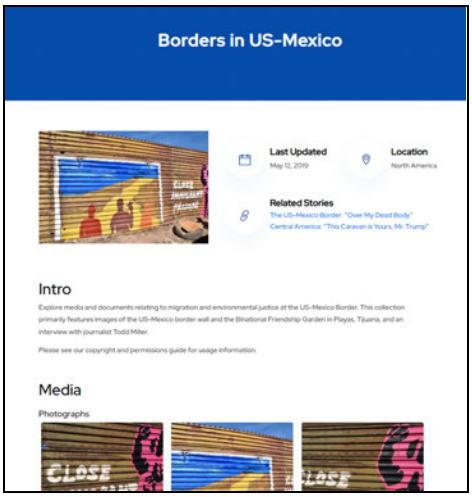


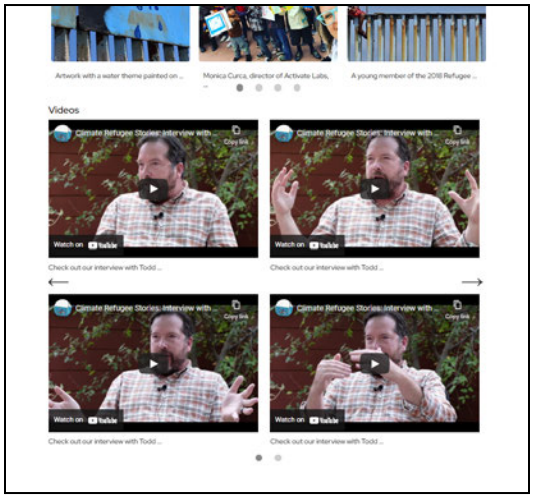
You can edit the following in [Main Pages/Archive]:

- Page Title, Archive Tags for Each Category

  Note: While you can add tags to these category dropdowns, I would not recommend going past the current longest list (just for best visual layout). You can always remove/replace ones you don’t find yourself using as well.

Individual Collection Page







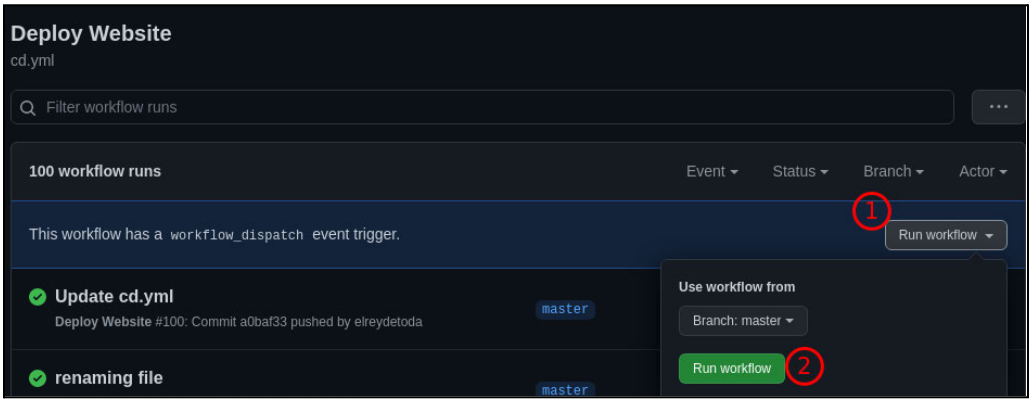


**You can edit the following in [Archive](): **

- All Individual Collection Page Content *****Except for Pics/Videos in the Media Gallery*****

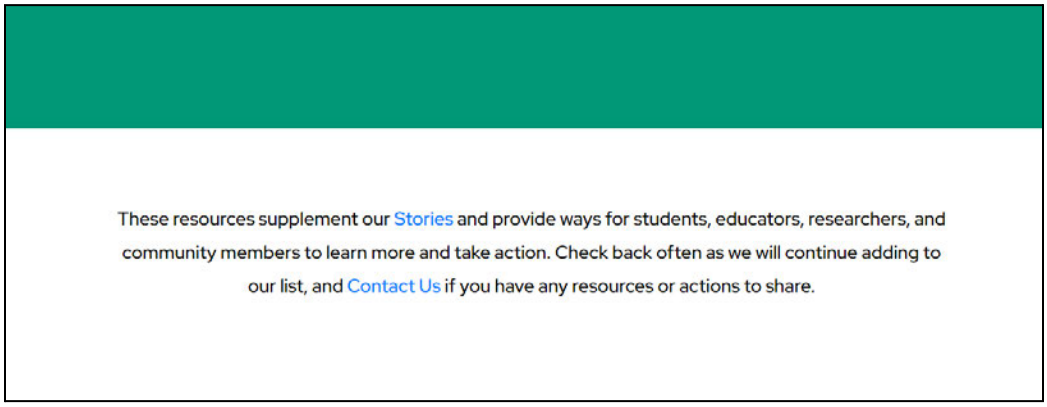
  Note: The thumbnail and cover photo is added through the CMS. The Media Gallery pictures and videos will need to be added to the CSV file, and you will use the Collection Title to specify which collection those pictures and/or videos should be shown on.

  If you're only adding to the CSV you will need to manually kick off the redeployment of the website, and this will automatically grab the updated information from the CSV. You can do that by navigating [here]() and then clicking the following buttons.



Resources

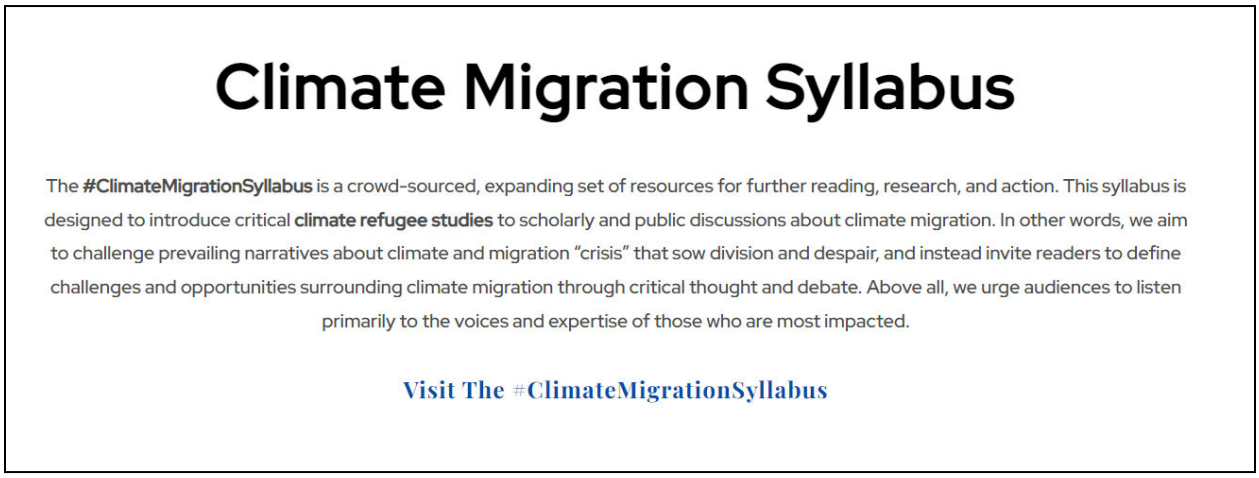
Introduction Section



You can edit the following in Main Pages/Resources:

- Page Title, Intro Paragraph

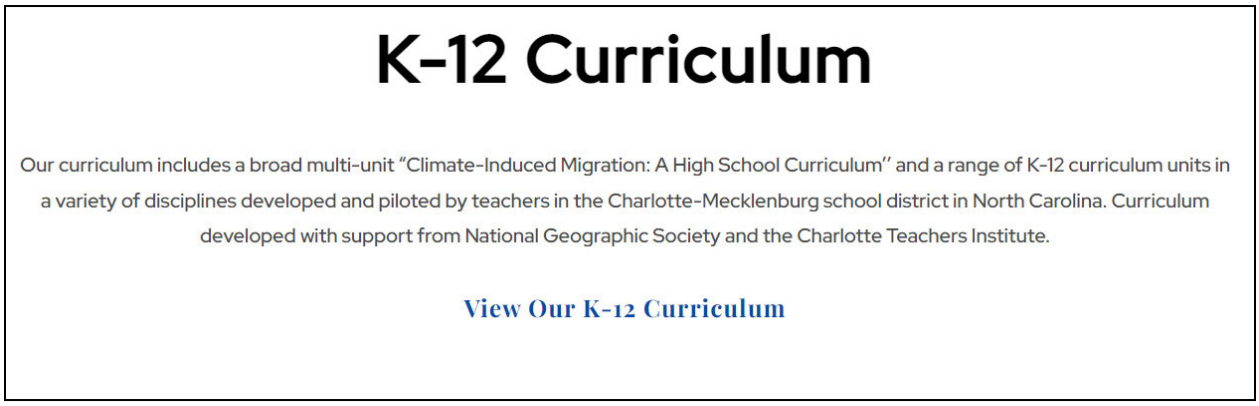
Climate Migration Syllabus Section



You can edit the following in Resources/Climate Migration Syllabus:

- Section Title, Section Content, Button Label + Link (Visit The #Climate…)

K-12 Curriculum Section



You can edit the following in Resources/K-12 Curriculum:

- Section Title, Section Content, Button Label + Link (View Our K-12…)

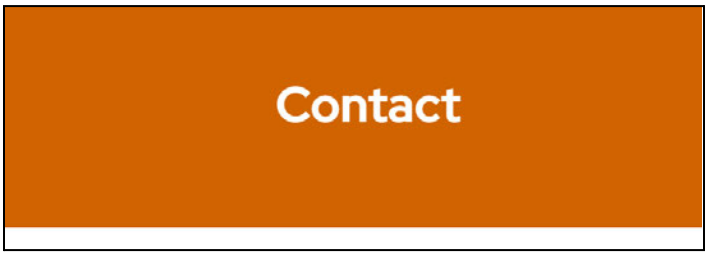
Take Action Section



You can edit the following in Resources/Take Action:

- Section Title, Section Content, Button Label + Link (Click Here for Ways…)

Contact



You can edit the following in [Main Pages/Contact]:

- Page Title

Get in Touch Section

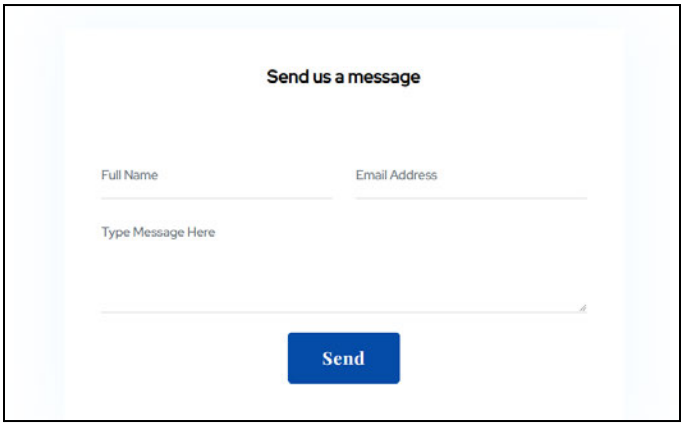


You can edit the following in [Main Pages/Contact]:

- Section Title (Get in Touch), Text Above Socials Icons, Socials (Icons + Links), Text Above Newsletter, Newsletter Button + Link

  Note: Social icons + link changes affect those on this page and the home page. The Newsletter link affects the one in the popup at the bottom of the screen (subscribe or dismiss message).

Send Us A Message Form

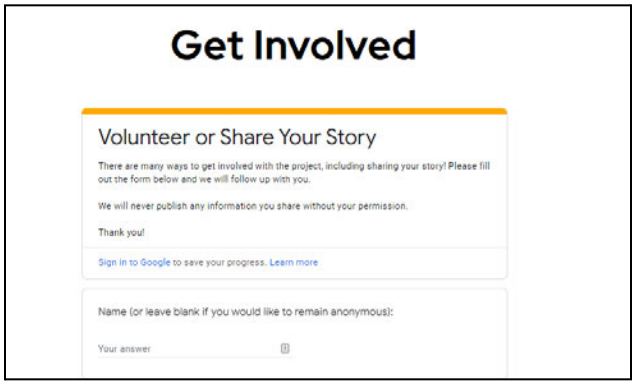


You can edit the following in [Main Pages/Contact]:

- Text Above the Form (Send us a message), All Text Fields for Titles, Form Link

  Note: The current form link is set up with Forspree and that may need to be updated if you want to change the link for this.

Get Involved Form



You can edit the following in [Main Pages/Contact]:

- Text Above the Form (Get Involved), Form Link

  Note: If you want to edit the color of the form, that is through the Google form itself. It doesn't always show up on the website as the same color as it does when editing the Google form, so it's good to check the color the submit button and such appear on the website to make sure they are accessible colors with high contrast.

Overall

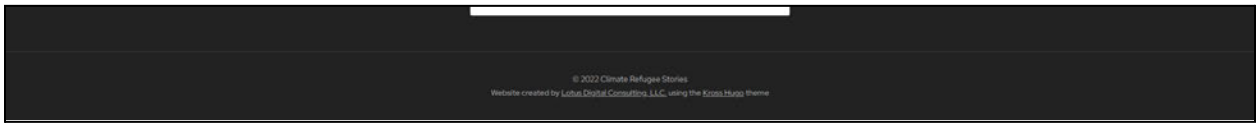
Favicon



You cannot edit this section in the CMS, but the GitHub file path is included below:

- static/images/favicon.png → replace this image with one with exactly the same name
    - OR can change the name (image path) in layouts/partials/head.html Lines 77-78

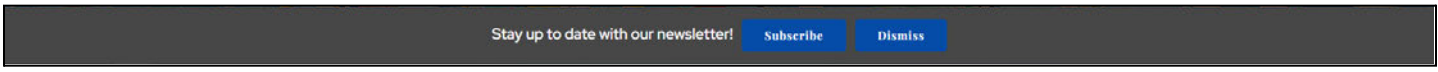
Footer Section



You cannot edit this section in the CMS, but the GitHub file path is included below:

- layouts/partials/footer.html → Lines 5 - 7

Newsletter Offer



You cannot edit this section in the CMS, but the GitHub file path is included below:

- layouts/partials/footer.html → Lines 35 - 37

General Styling

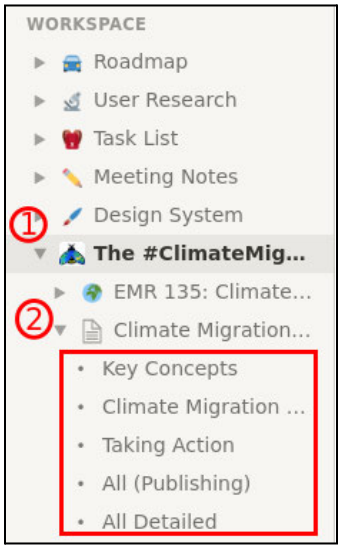
If changes are wanted regarding things like: Menu, Fonts, Colors, Effects, or anything else that wasn't listed as something that can be edited in the CMS or GitHub easily, that would be something we could come back to work on in the future. See more in the Future Options section.

Climate Migration Syllabus Breakdown

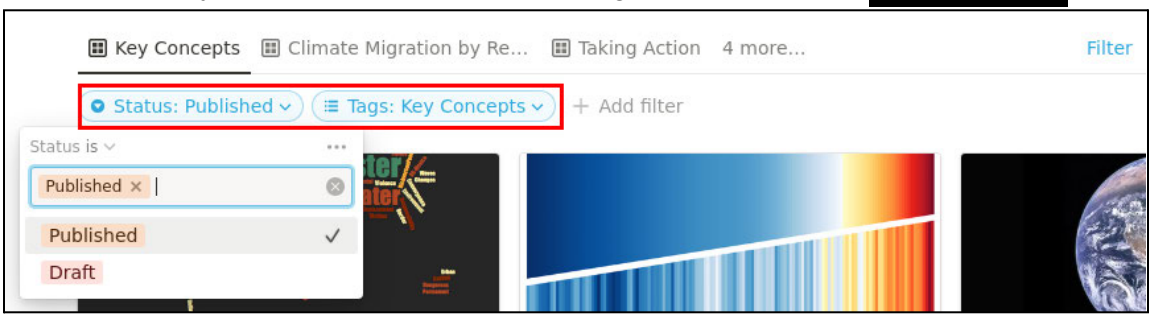
General Setup

When editing with Notion, you can quickly access the different table views by the side bar on the far left. You can click the ➡ and it'll drop down the pages/databases embedded in the "The #ClimateMigrationSyllabus" page.

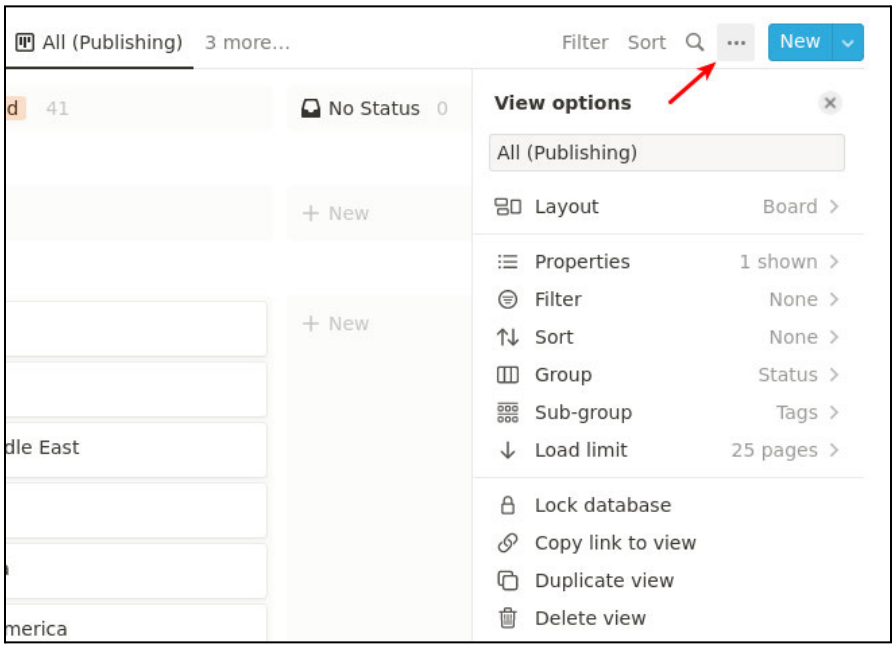
Clicking the next ➡ on the "Climate Migration Syllabus DB" will expand out the different "views" of the database (db). Having easy access to these lets you quickly add content to each different section.



Each view is configured slightly differently. The main 3 (Key Concepts, Climate Migration by Region, & Taking Action) are all using predefined filters to filter out the different posts based on the tags (explained a bit later) tied to each post. When wanting a new post to show up in one of those three categories it must **always** have the “Status” of “Published”, and the corresponding Tags. This means posts can (but don't have to) show up in multiple categories if you want to, but no matter what you **must** have the published tag. That leads to the [redacted]…



You can dig a bit more into the settings to see how I configured everything by clicking on the ellipse in the top right corner on each view, and it'll show you all the settings I configured for everything.



So far I've shown just the higher level view of how things are organized. If you click on any individual page you'll see how the information is tracked on a per page basis. The other views allow you to easily view and move them around to the different states, but you could easily add them to each individual page during the page creation.

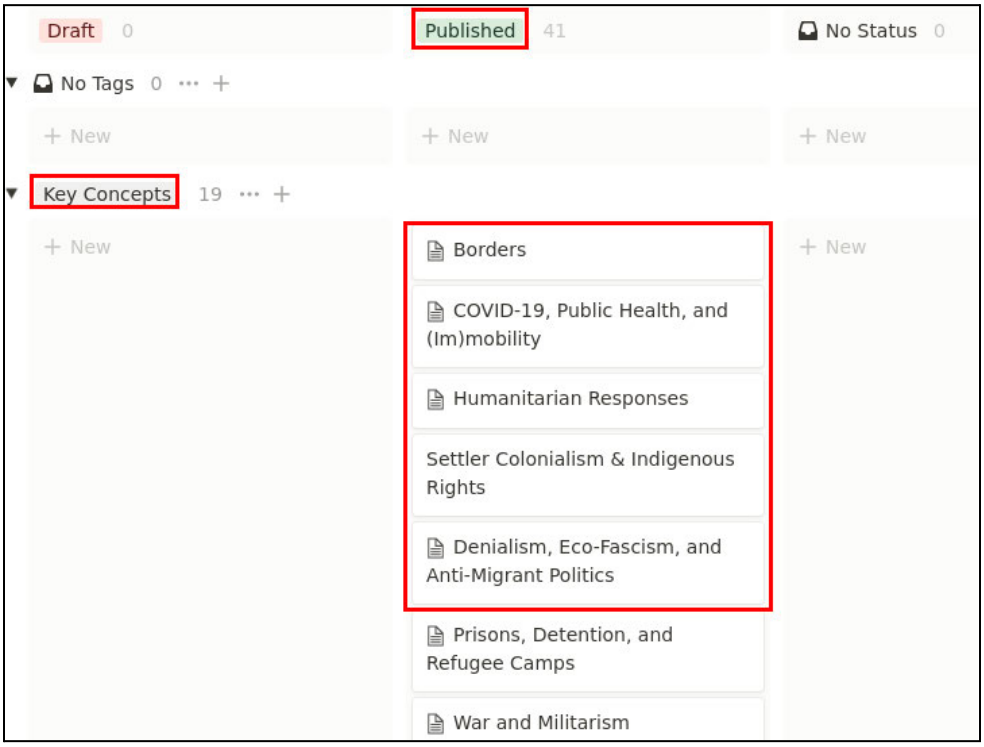
To create a new tag or status (while on an individual page), start typing the name in the corresponding property field (i.e. Status or Tags) you'd like to give it and if it doesn't exist when you hit enter it'll create it for you.



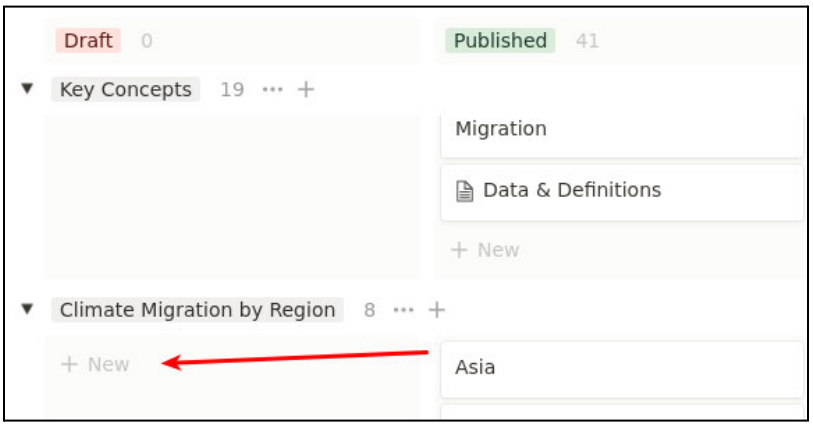
Managing Content

The All (Publishing) view is a view that helps show currently published (per tag group). As you want to move pages from draft to published it'll show up in the corresponding area. As you can see in the picture, it shows all the "Key Concepts" tagged posts that are also “Status” “Published”. You can also track if there is no tag/status on a specific post and assign it to the appropriate column just by dragging to the desired location.

In the future you can add more Tags/Status categories, but if you want them to be displayed in gallery view (easy for people to see) then you'll also need to add another view for that new Tags category.



Another cool feature is that if you know you want to make a draft page for another "Climate Migration by Region", you can click the new button under the corresponding Column (Draft) + Row (Climate Migration by Region).



Afterwards it'll give you an empty text box for the page name, and after you type the name and hit enter.



It'll tag the page automatically with both sets of tags that matched up to the columns you created it in.



GitHub

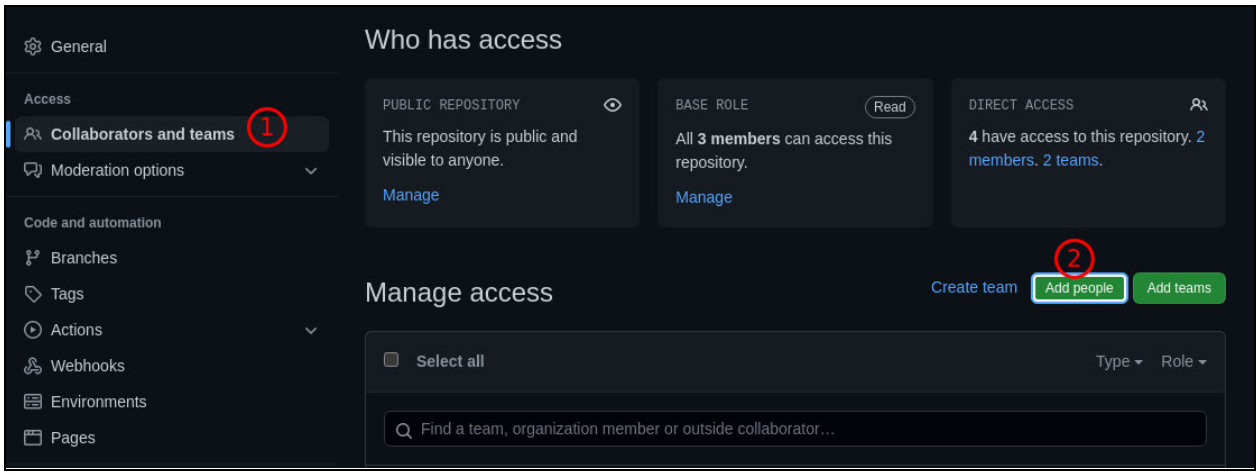
About

GitHub is one of the most popular Git hosting sites, and you can learn more here.

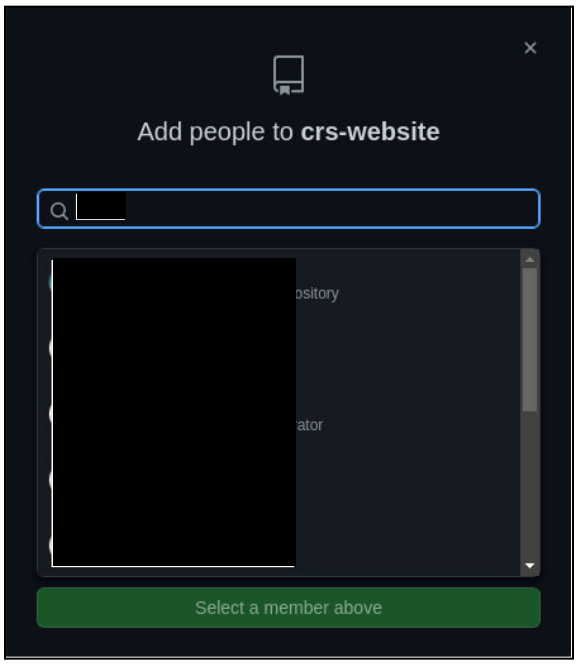
Repo Breakdown

Settings

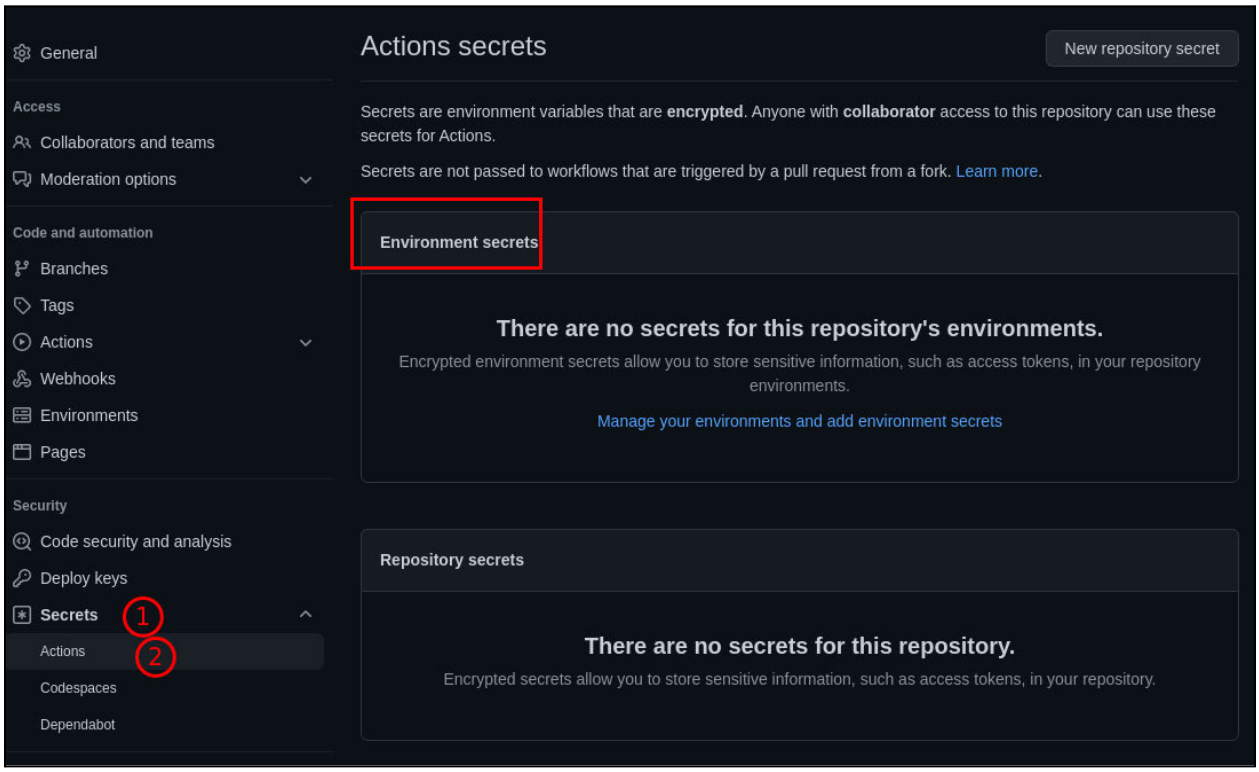
If you want to add outside collaborators to specifically the CRS repo, you can add them by going to the settings and then clicking the following buttons (pic below).



This will give you a prompt to search for people on GitHub, and you can invite them as an outside collaborator.



This next section has very sensitive information, which could give access to your account via a secret key (which is needed for the automation). Do not share or show this information to anyone that doesn't need it (most likely no one will).



As documented under here in the "You can edit the following in the Archive" section, you can manually start the website rebuild if for some reason you are getting not updated information.

Folder/File Purposes

The following is a general breakdown of the folders/files you will see in your project repo. You will likely not need to use any of this information, but we thought we'd include it in case you were curious or wanted to explore it in the future.

.github

This folder contains subfolders/files for repository automation.

assets

This folder contains all the styling (CSS/SCSS) and dynamic functionality (JS) for the website.

content

This contains all the authored information on the website.

about

This folder has _index.md for main About page content, as well as team members and bottom sections of the page (CRS News and Usage Guide).

archive

This folder has _index.md for main Archive page content, as well as individual collection pages.

contact

This folder has _index.md for main Contact page content, including social icons and contact forms.

resources

This folder has _index.md for the intro paragraph, as well as pages for each of the Resources sections.

stories

This folder has _index.md for main Stories page content, as well as individual story pages.

_index.md

This file has the content for the home page. (All content goes to layouts/index.html)

data

This folder holds the archive data for the deployed site (only on live site).

layouts

This folder contains html files (structure of content) for all pages/sections of the website.

static

This folder contains all content that is directly accessible on the website repo

admin

All the files in this folder are related to the Netlify CMS.

asset_backups

These are backup files for all the JS and CSS that is pulled into the website.

images

This contains a couple background illustrations and the favicon for the website.

themes

This folder contains the original Kross Hugo theme content and should not be modified. In order to customize things, we essentially overrode what we needed to in the crs-website repo rather than edit anything in the themes folder specifically.

.gitattributes

This file is used to specify how you want to read/interpret certain attributes of your files inside of the git repo.

.gitignore

This file is used to specify what we don't want to include in the repo. (There are dynamically generated files when the Hugo server is run that we can just tell it to ignore.)

.gitmodules

This file is used to specify what other repos you want to include (like the Kross Hugo theme's repo).

.hugo_build.lock

Hugo uses this during the build process.

CNAME

This is how we configure GitHub pages to point to your domain name.

README.md

This file is what is displayed on the GitHub repo as essentially general info on what that repo is for.

config.toml

Instructs Hugo on how we want things configured.

netlify.toml

This file is used for the deployment previews.

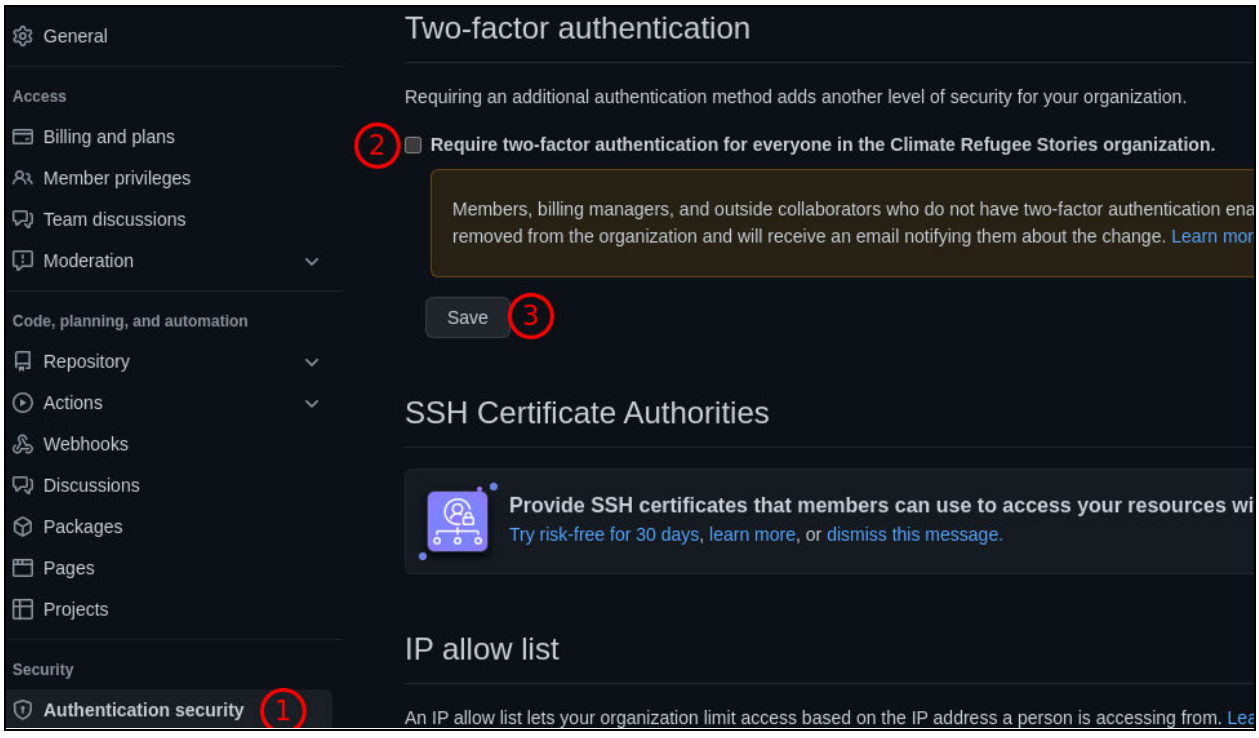
Organization Breakdown

Settings

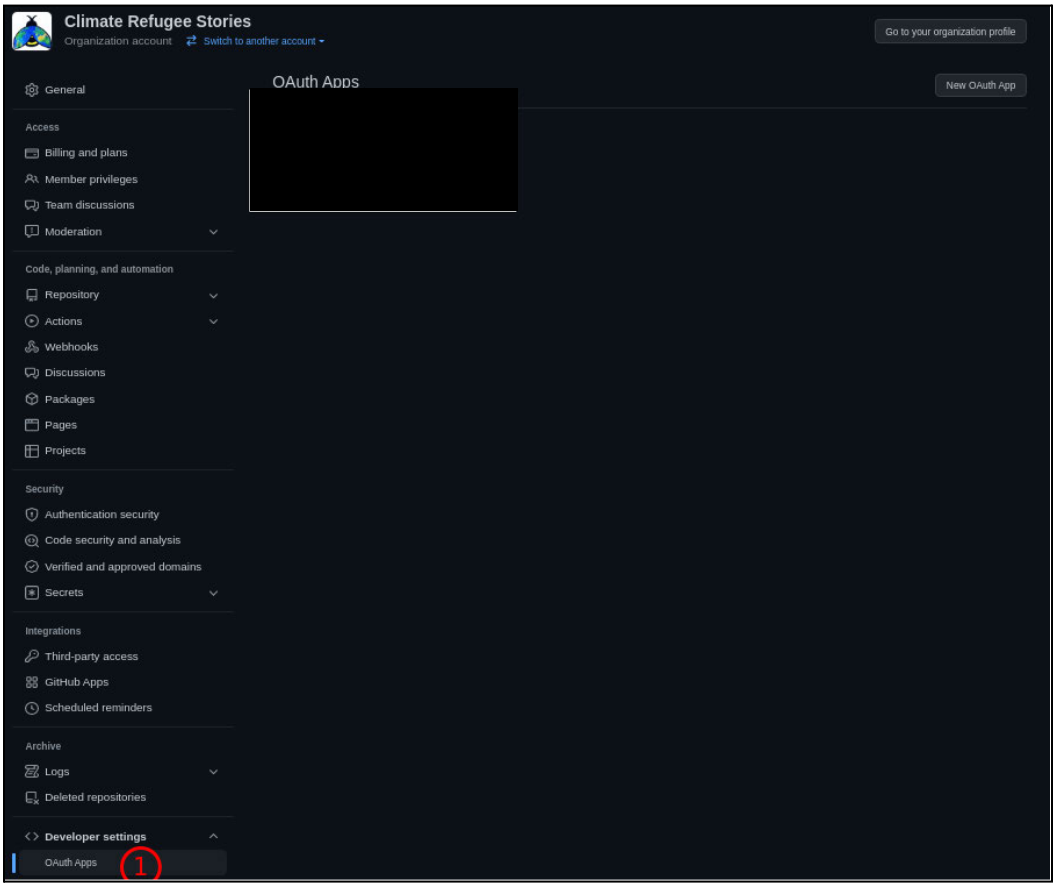
When you want to allow someone to edit the CRS repo, instead of adding them directly as an editor to the repo you can add them to the CRS-editors team. This gives them edit access over the repo and will allow them to author content on the CRS repo.

When someone is not part of your core team, you should consider adding them as an outside collaborator. This will come with some inherent restrictions of privileges, mainly that you'll be adding them to an individual repo instead of your organization. However, it should allow them to do what they need to do, and then you can remove them when they're done.

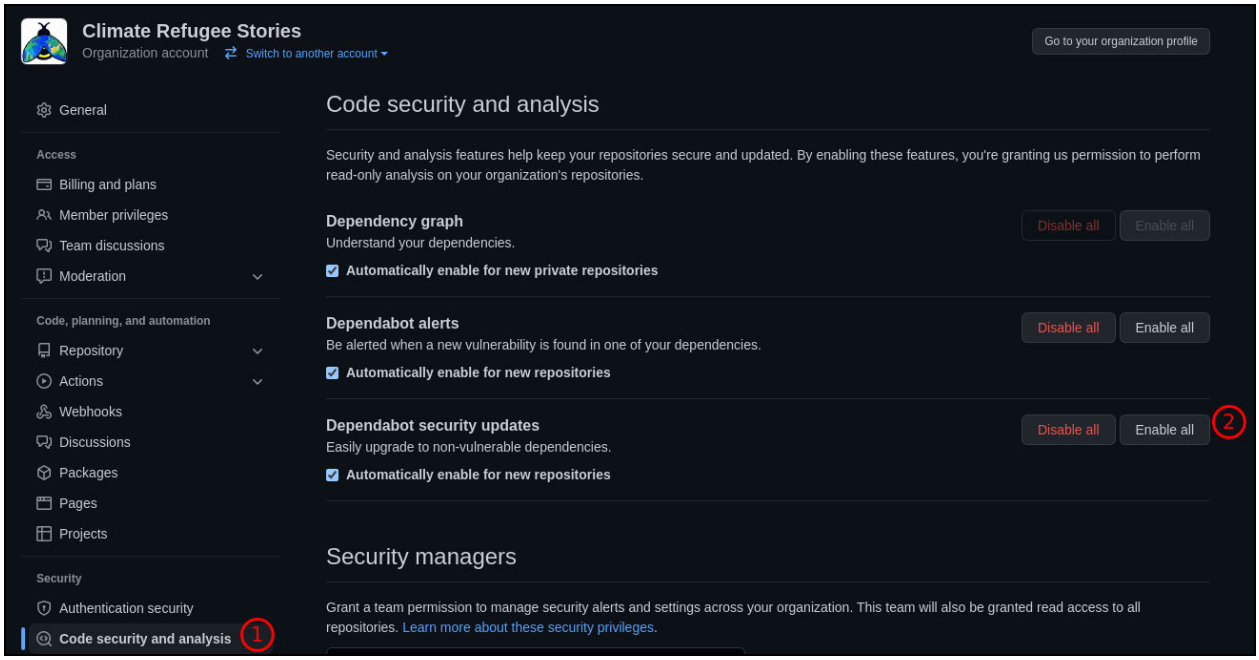
This setting should probably be enabled (pic below), and I would require all of your members to have two factor authentication (2fa or 2FA). This will help your organization to be more secure and help prevent your members account's from being hacked more easily (which could cause website defacement or worse). Using Bitwarden they should be able to store the 2fa codes with a free account, but if not they can use an app like Authy to do so. See more on password management here.



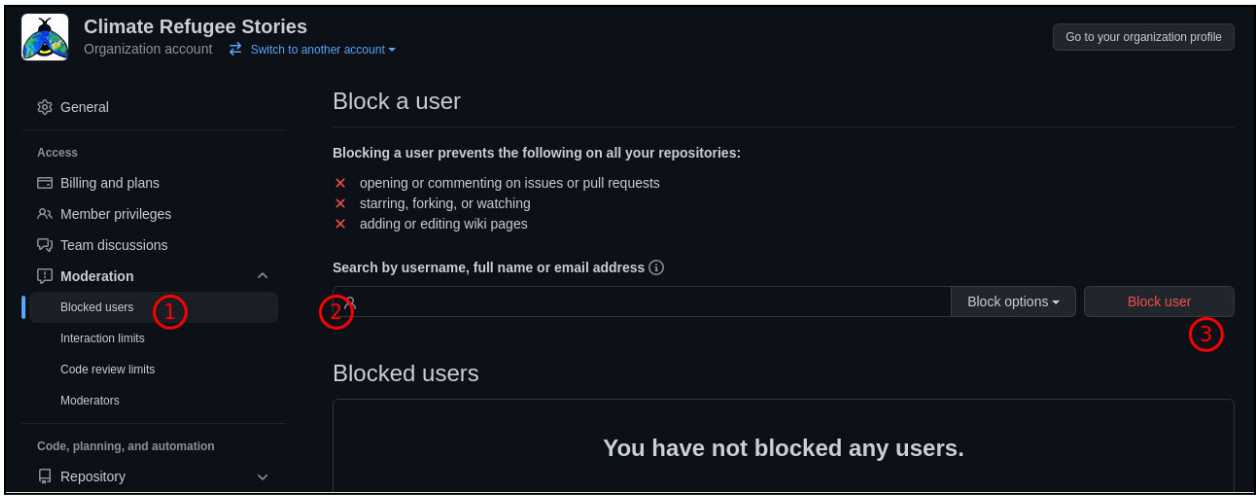
Note: Do NOT remove this OAuth application (image below), it's used to authenticate the repo to the Netlify CMS.



I've enabled code security and analysis (pic below), so the repo will automatically be scanned and checked for vulnerabilities. There shouldn't be any serious vulnerabilities (mostly on backend infrastructure, which isn't directly accessible to attackers, since the main website is mainly HTML, CSS, and Javascript).



If a user account is harassing your organization, you can block said users here:



There are other moderation options as well below the block users options. This might be good to explore in case there are any incidents with malicious people.

Accounts

GitHub

Use

GitHub holds the Climate Refugee Stories website project files in the crs-website repo, and this site is being deployed with GitHub Pages. Here is GitHub's Documentation and GitHub Pages Documentation.

Access

You should already have access to the crs-website repo with your GitHub account, and you have been made an admin. You also now own the organization account Climate-Refugee-Stories, so you will be able to add team members as needed and control access.

I will remove Alex from the repo, and you can remove me from the repo and the CRS org account as soon as the automation is complete. Then you could add us back in the future if needed. You can see more about suggestions with this in the GitHub subsection of Sharing Access below.

Misc

GitHub has something for teachers now that you could check out.

GoDaddy

Use

GoDaddy is used for purchasing domain names, as they are a domain name registrar, and *can* be used for managing your domain name system (DNS) records (for the domains you purchase). They are very limited though, which prevented us from configuring GitHub pages via their DNS manager, so we've opted to use Cloudflare for managing your DNS records.

Access

You should have access to this with your original account prior to this project.

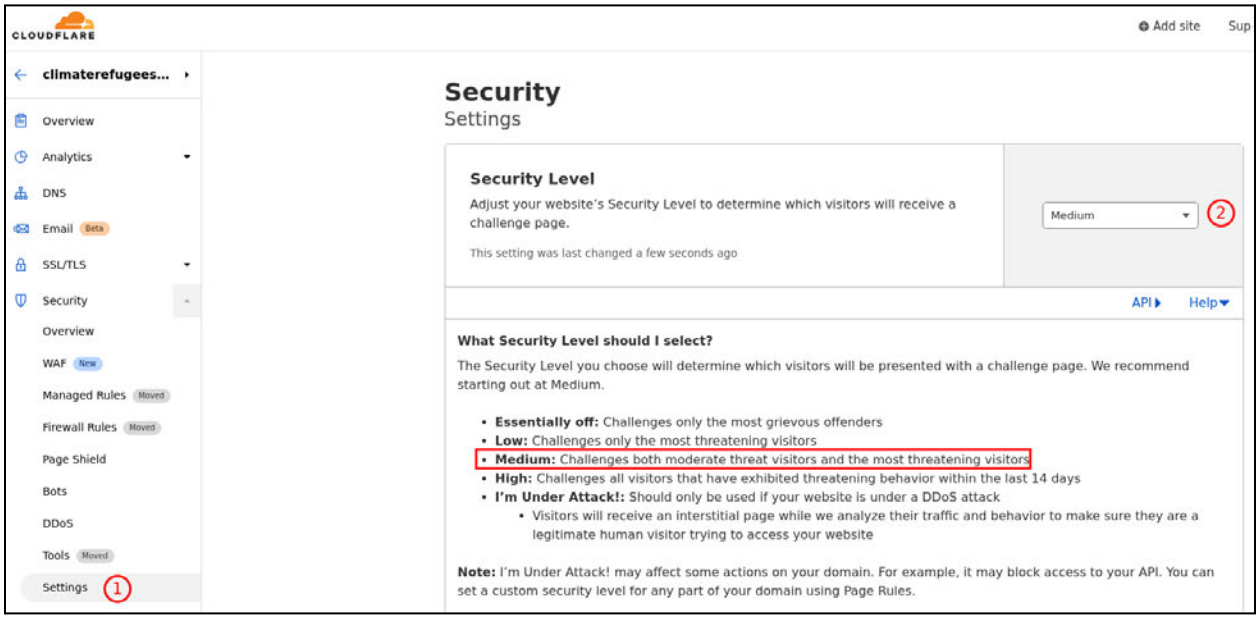
Cloudflare

Use

Cloudflare is used mainly for managing your DNS records. This is what allows people to find your website from their browser. Think of it like a phonebook or an index for finding all the websites on the internet.

For the Climate Migration Syllabus, you also use Cloudflare for pointing to your Notion page to make it look like a website. This is done via their Cloudflare workers and it looks like you followed this tutorial to configure it. In the future, if you need to change pages, all you need to do is swap out the slug (check the YouTube video for what this means [redacted]) and click the “Save and Deploy” button.

All domains have a Medium security level set for the domain, picture below shows how it was set. This should not be intrusive for normal users, but will help prevent malicious people from using automated attacks against your website.



Access

You should have access to this with your original account prior to this project.

Notion

Use

Notion is used for hosting the Climate Migration Syllabus

Access

You should have access to this with your original account prior to this project.

ArchGIS

Use

ArchGIS is used for creating and maintaining a map of all the story locations that are displayed in the Stories section of the home page.

Access

You should have access to this with your account used to create the Stories map.

reCaptcha

Use

reCaptcha is to help verify those attempting to use the "Send us a message" form on your Contact page. It was set up with your CRS gmail account and is free to use with Google.

Access

You should have access to this with your original CRS gmail account prior to this project. You can view the reCaptcha dashboard [redacted] and edit the settings [redacted]. If editing this, the secret key will also need to be changed in your Formspree account (see info on that below).

Formspree

Use

Formspree is used to connect your "Send us a message" form on the Contact page with your CRS gmail. This allows you to receive messages without people having to use your gmail

directly (which helps as another layer of protection from spam and such). You are currently on the free plan (they put that plan at the bottom of the page, separate from the list of others).

Access

This account was created with your CRS gmail, and you will have received the password at our final meeting.

SmugMug

Use

SmugMug is used for a cost-effective unlimited storage of photos for the website, and you should be on the basic - plan.

Access

You should have access to this with your account created when signing up for SmugMug.

Algolia

Use

Algolia is used for searching for different Stories via titles, tags, summaries, or descriptions, and you are on the free plan.

Access

This account was created with your CRS gmail, and you will have received the password at our final meeting.

Netlify

Use

Netlify is used for the Content Management System (CMS) and deploy previews, and you are on the free (starter) plan.

Access

You should have access to this with your GitHub account.

Security Recommendations

General Best Practices

This could be a guide in it of itself 😅, but generally it's best practice to have longer, randomly generated passwords (also unique, not reused for any accounts) and enable two factor authentication for as many accounts as possible. Incorporating those things where possible, especially 2fa (which you can normally find by googling "enable 2fa on xyz" (i.e. enable 2fa on Gmail)), you can be reasonably assured that you're secure.

Another major possible attack vector is social engineering. If someone claims to work for a company and you haven't engaged said company at all, you should be suspicious of that and either ask them to prove it or call the company to validate they're working there. Normally support for companies allow you to send emails to their general support, so you could forward them any emails in question (just make sure it doesn't have any sensitive information in them before forwarding).

When it comes to sharing accounts or materials with others, even those on your team, it is good to question who truly needs access to what, as well as if they *still* need access to things. We have expanded on this in the Sharing Access section.

Password Management

Password managers are an index of all your secrets, so they should be taken care of with the utmost security and care to ensure that you don't allow a malicious person to get ahold of your account.

Here is a YouTube video comparing the two:
Bitwarden vs Lastpass - What's the Best Password Manager?!

General Suggestions

It's best practice to create all the passwords you use via a password manager's random password generator (Bitwarden & Lastpass). A good length for a password is about 20-25 characters, and you will only need to remember 1 good password which is to login to your password manager. This will allow you to create secure passwords, but not have to worry about trying to remember every single one.

When using a password manager another need is normally two factor authentication (2fa or 2FA), and this can be provided either by the password manager (for Bitwarden) or via a 3rd party app like Authy.

Tools

Bitwarden

Bitwarden has generally been considered more secure, because of its Open Source nature which allows more people to audit and review it. It's also been more public about security vulnerabilities that have been found by penetration testers that they've hired, which they of course secure/fix before releasing the results.

Bitwarden overall is normally cheaper than Lastpass, but it depends on what type of account you want to pay for and which feels more intuitive for you. When it comes to the lower tier account for both of them, Bitwarden allows you to use a "hack" to share passwords (talked about in the sharing section), while Lastpass requires you to pay $36/year (only for 1 personal account) to enable that feature (one to many sharing).

They also offer non-profit/educational pricing.

Storage

You would store all your passwords in Bitwarden, and you can see more on that here.

Sharing

Depending on your account type, you can share passwords via Bitwarden. If you have a team account you can share them via organizations.

If you're going to be using a personal account, and sharing passwords with team members individually then there is only really 1 way to do it relatively securely. You will need to get the personal premium account ($10/year) and that will give you access to Bitwarden Send. From there, you can create a text send with the password you want to share with a team member. You can give them the link for the send, and they can copy it into a secure location (preferably another password manager).

LastPass

They tend to offer a bit more simple and declarative interface, but also tend to be more expensive. They also have a bit more restrictions with the base free account, where you can only login to 1 device and can only share passwords with only one other person (not sharing to many accounts like their paid accounts).

They don't offer non-profit pricing, but something for colleges/universities.

Lastpass has had a security incident in the past (contrary to me not finding any examples of hacks against Bitwarden), but overall they've instilled just as much faith in security as Bitwarden has (at least as much as they can without being as transparent as Bitwarden).

Storage

You would store all your passwords in Lastpass, and you can see more on that here.

Sharing

This will require you at least have a personal premium account to allow you to share passwords with more than one other person. If the person doesn't have a Lastpass account, it requires them to signup for a free version of lastpass (which has restrictions like only being able to sign in from one device type (i.e. mobile or desktop)).

Sharing Access

Generally it's best practice to follow the principle of least privilege (only give people access to the absolute minimum they need access to do their job). This normally helps prevent security incidents from giving someone too much permission and them abusing or unsuspectingly getting hacked themselves.

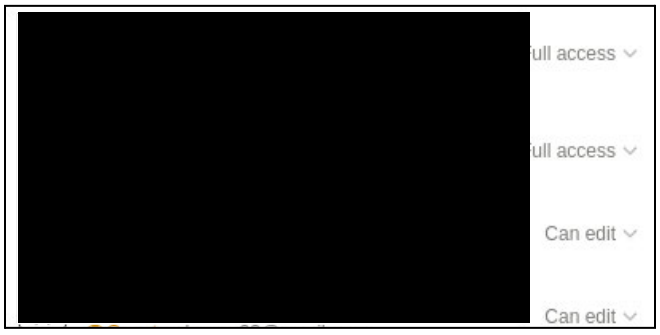
For most of these accounts (if not all), no one should need *your* account username and password. They should have their own account created and they can access, modify, etc. through that instead of using your account or a shared account. This also helps identify if something does happen, and allows you to properly identify who did said malicious action.

If, however, there is an account where someone is sharing login credentials, it is best practice to change the password when they no longer need access.

Notion

Who Needs Access

Any contributors to your Climate Migration Syllabus. I've already added all the people who were initially on the Climate Refugee Stories organization and given them edit access (which was the same level of access before). You should probably delete the old Notion org, so you don't get charged for it and to help with confusion.



Ways to Share

You can share access to individual pages (which should grant the same level of access to sub-pages) by adding people as Guests to the page. Normally they probably won't need more than edit access, but I've added the CRS gmail as Full access as well (since it's the organization's email).

Once someone is done creating/editing content (if they aren't regular content creators), it is good to remove them until they need access again.

GitHub

Who Needs Access

Anyone who needs to add/update content directly in the Climate Refugee Stories website's code or help with GitHub settings and such. They most-likely don't need more than edit access on the repo, which can be granted by adding them to the CRS-editors team.

Ways to Share

You can add people to the organization and team, and the team should be the CRS-editors team (linked above). You can see more on the GitHub setup above.

Google Drive

Who Needs Access

Anyone who you want to update the Google Sheet which displays its info on the Archive page's media section (pictures and videos). They most-likely don't need more than edit or comment access (do **NOT** make them owner of the file, you could lose access if you do this).

We recommend comment access where they could add their suggestions and you approve them (so you being the only one with edit access). This can help avoid any accidental deletes or someone mistakenly editing columns or something. Usually Google would have a version history that you can revert to, but I believe that is something that could be deleted as well.

If there is someone who will be helping you on a regular basis with content creation and such for photos and videos in these galleries, you could give them edit access. It's just good to only give access to who is absolutely necessary and only while it's necessary (remove when they aren't needed). This is the easiest way to help keep all your gallery work protected.

Ways to Share

You can see more on sharing here.

CMS

Who Needs Access

Anyone who needs to update or add new content.

Ways to Share

This is controlled via GitHub authorization, so anyone who has write access to the repository can access this with their GitHub account.

CRS Gmail

Who Needs Access

Honestly I don't think anyone *needs* access to this email directly. If for some reason someone does need access to *specific* emails, then you could set up forwarding rules to send those *specific* emails to their address.

This email is used to login to most of your accounts, and if someone gains access to this email they could lock you out of your accounts by changing your password, username, or login email.

Ways to Share

See more on setting up email forwarding here.

Information Privacy

General Best Practices

This could be a guide in it of itself as well 😅, but in summary the less sensitive information (emails, account names, etc…) you have public the better. This is why it is also good to use contact forms, like the one on the website, or Google forms, where people are not contacting you directly.

Here is a pretty good article on privacy.

Photo Metadata (exif data)

This article shows you how to remove exif (photo metadata) from photos and prevent it in the future. This typically isn't as serious, but it is good to remove any info you can before putting things online because we don't always know how someone may be able to use certain pieces of information for malicious purposes.

Future Options

LDC Contract Work

Consultations

If further work is needed or you'd like things such as larger updates, redesigns, enhancements, etc., we'd be happy to come back and work on things again. These would just be under a new contract, and we could have a consultation to discuss your plans and ideas to determine what that work and timeline would look like.

Offerings

Here are some different kinds of work we could offer in the future:

- Website Updates/Redesigns
    - Editing the current site, adding enhancements/features, redesigning things, etc.
    - This could also be helping to incorporate other tools, change current tools, etc.

- Security Consultations
    - Discussing security setups, tools, helping with questions, etc.

- Security Implementations
    - Setting up tools/processes with you to help with security

- Video Editing
    - Ashley could edit video content and help with managing your YouTube channel content

- Analytics/Interactive Features
    - This could be incorporating something like Google Analytics, commenting and sharing features, etc. to have ways to track visitors and engagement on the website

- General infrastructure design and consultation
    - This would most likely be if you wanted to deploy or develop some type of application offering, and wanted help with the application design and development.
    - This could also be used to help validate that someone else you're contracting work through is designing a secure and well designed system for you.

- Other General IT wants or requests
    - This could be a catch all for any other general IT help, and we could help with miscellaneous tasks that are either difficult to do or ones you might be having trouble with. We could also attempt (or inform you if it's possible) to automate difficult tasks for you.

If you come across an idea/situation that we haven't listed here, we would still be happy to have a consultation to discuss it and see what we could do!

Working with Other Contractors

If you end up hiring another developer down the road, have others working on content, etc. and they run into any problems, want to discuss the setup further, etc., we would be happy to offer consultations with them as well.

We have thoroughly enjoyed getting to work on this project with you, and we are so excited to see it all come together! If you have any questions at all while you are exploring this guide or the setup in general, or would like to discuss further work, please don't hesitate to send us an email at [redacted] (our new business email)